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*LDCE Inspector Posts | PS Group B*

## STUDY NOTES

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**Brochure on Reservation, Instructions Regarding Sports  
Person Reservation, and Compassionate Appointment  
Guidelines Issued by Department of Posts and DoP&T**

Prepared by: Dak Guru Content Team

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## Preface & Scope of the Topic

This study module consolidates three distinct but interrelated subjects relevant to the LDCE Inspector Posts / PS Group B examination under Paper III (Establishment, Accounts & Rules). The three subjects share a common feature: each provides for an exception or relaxation to the normal direct recruitment procedure laid down by the Recruitment Rules of a cadre, and each is grounded in policy instructions issued by the nodal Department of Personnel & Training (DoP&T) and adapted by the Department of Posts (DoP) through Establishment Division instructions issued from time to time.

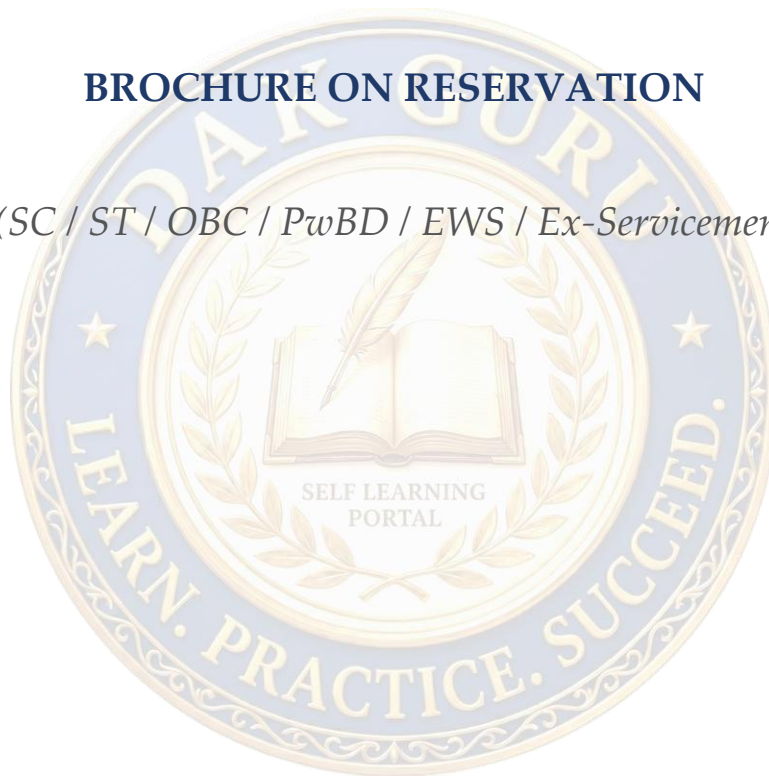
Areas covered:

- Reservation policy for Scheduled Castes (SCs), Scheduled Tribes (STs), Other Backward Classes (OBCs), Persons with Benchmark Disabilities (PwBDs), Economically Weaker Sections (EWS) and Ex-servicemen — as consolidated in the DoP&T Brochure / Compendium of Instructions on Reservation in Appointments/Services updated on 14.10.2022 and the consolidated DoP&T O.M. dated 28.03.2024.
- Sports persons reservation — as per DoP&T consolidated instructions issued vide O.M. No. DOPT-1711450898768 dated 04.03.2024, which now serves as the single authoritative compilation, and the Department of Posts Sports Quota Recruitment notifications issued vide W-17/55/2022-SPN-I.
- Compassionate appointment — as per DoP&T Master Circular dated 02.08.2022 (read with O.M. dated 23.08.2021 on procedure), and the Department of Posts Revised Relative Merit Points System (RMPS-2022) issued vide letter No. 17-1/2022-SPG-II dated 23.03.2022 (which supersedes the earlier RMPS dated 28.09.2020 and 20.01.2010).

**Exam Tip:** These three topics together usually account for 4–6 marks in Paper II. Most questions are factual one-liners (percentages, OM numbers, authority levels, age limits, vacancy ceilings) and small case scenarios. Memorise the percentages, the date of the latest consolidating OM, and the names of the committees (CRC at DoP / RMC at central level). Pay equal attention to all three sub-topics; in recent papers, sports quota and compassionate appointment have been more frequently asked than the reservation brochure itself.

## **BROCHURE ON RESERVATION**

*(SC / ST / OBC / PwBD / EWS / Ex-Servicemen)*





## Chapter 1 — Constitutional & Statutory Framework

### 1.1 The Constitutional Mandate

Reservation in services under the State has its primary constitutional basis in Article 16(4), which empowers the State to make any provision for reservation of appointments or posts in favour of any backward class of citizens which, in the opinion of the State, is not adequately represented in the services under the State. The provision is an enabling one and not mandatory.

- Article 16(4A) — inserted by the 77th Constitutional Amendment, 1995 — empowers the State to make provision for reservation in matters of promotion in favour of SCs and STs with consequential seniority (further inserted by 85th Amendment, 2001 with retrospective effect from 17.06.1995).
- Article 16(4B) — inserted by 81st Amendment, 2000 — permits carry-forward of unfilled SC/ST/OBC vacancies of a year as a separate class of vacancies in succeeding years and excludes such backlog from the 50% ceiling.
- Article 16(6) — inserted by 103rd Constitutional Amendment, 2019 — provides for reservation up to 10% for EWS of citizens, in addition to existing reservations.
- Article 335 — requires that claims of SCs and STs be taken into consideration consistently with the maintenance of efficiency of administration in making appointments to services and posts.
- Article 341 / 342 / 342A — Presidential power to specify by Public Notification the castes, races or tribes which shall be deemed to be SCs / STs / SEBCs in relation to a State or Union Territory; modifications can be made only by Parliament.

### 1.2 The Nodal Authority

The Department of Personnel & Training (DoP&T), under the Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions, is the nodal department of the Government of India for issuing instructions on reservation in services. The Establishment (Reservation) Division of DoP&T issues OMs/orders consolidating instructions from time to time. In the Department of Posts, the SPB-I / SPB-II / SPG-II sections of the Postal Directorate (Establishment Division) administer these policies.

### 1.3 The Brochure / Compendium on Reservation

The expression "Brochure on Reservation" refers to the consolidated handbook of instructions issued by DoP&T that compiles all standing OMs on the subject under self-contained chapters with hyperlinks to the underlying OMs. The Brochure is in two parts: Part I (self-contained statement of provisions) and Part II (the underlying OMs).

*[Source: DoP&T O.M. No. 36011/1/2013-Estt(Res) dated 30.01.2014 — issuance of revised brochure; updated again by O.M. dated 14.10.2022 (compendium for SC/ST/OBC/PwBD/EWS); and most recently revised vide DoP&T O.M. No. 36011/1/2022-Estt(Res-I) dated 28.03.2024.]*

**Latest Consolidating Order:** DoP&T O.M. No. 36011/1/2022-Estt(Res-I) dated 28.03.2024 — "Reservation for SCs, STs, OBCs, PwDs and EWS in Posts and Services in the Central Government". This is the latest single-document reference and updates the earlier compendium of 14.10.2022.

### 1.4 The Two Modes of Direct Recruitment

Reservation in direct recruitment to civil posts and civil services under the Central Government is operated separately for the following two modes:

1. Recruitment on all-India basis by Open Competition (e.g., examinations conducted by UPSC/SSC) — applicable percentages: SC 15%, ST 7.5%, OBC 27%, EWS 10%.
2. Recruitment on all-India basis otherwise than by Open Competition (e.g., interview-only recruitment) — SC 16.66%, ST 7.5%, OBC 25.84%, EWS 10%.
3. Recruitment to Group C and erstwhile Group D posts which normally attract candidates from a locality or a region — percentages prescribed by the Administrative Ministries with reference to the population of SC/ST in the respective state/UT, subject to the 50% ceiling.

*[Source: DoP&T O.M. dated 28.03.2024 (consolidating instructions)]*

### 1.5 The 50% Ceiling and its Exception

As laid down by the Supreme Court in *Indra Sawhney v. Union of India* (AIR 1993 SC 477), the total reservation under Article 16(4) shall not ordinarily exceed 50% in any one year. The reservation for EWS under Article 16(6) being a separate class is over and above this 50% ceiling, taking total possible reservation to 59.5% for ordinary direct recruitment by open competition (15+7.5+27+10). The constitutional validity of the 10% EWS reservation has been upheld by the Constitution Bench in *Janhit Abhiyan v. Union of India* (2022) 7 SCC.

**Exam Tip:** Always remember:  $15 + 7.5 + 27 = 49.5\%$  for SC + ST + OBC, plus 10% for EWS = total 59.5% in direct open-competition recruitment. The 49.5% is the Indra Sawhney ceiling-compliant figure for the three socially backward categories.



## Chapter 2 — Quantum of Reservation in Direct Recruitment

### 2.1 Consolidated Table of Percentages

| Category                   | Open Competition (All-India)       | Otherwise than by Open Competition | Group C/D – Local/Regional       |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------|------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| SC                         | 15%                                | 16.66%                             | As per SC population of State/UT |
| ST                         | 7.5%                               | 7.5%                               | As per ST population of State/UT |
| OBC                        | 27%                                | 25.84%                             | Subject to 27% all-India cap     |
| EWS                        | 10%                                | 10%                                | 10%                              |
| PwBD (horizontal)          | 4% (1% each in four classes)       | 4%                                 | 4%                               |
| Ex-Servicemen (horizontal) | 10% (Group C); 20% (Group D)       | Same                               | Same                             |
| Meritorious Sportspersons  | Up to 5% (horizontal, Group C/D)   | —                                  | —                                |
| Compassionate Appointment  | Up to 5% of DR vacancies (Group C) | —                                  | —                                |

**Vertical vs Horizontal:** SC/ST/OBC/EWS reservations are 'vertical' — they apply to designated reserved points on the roster. PwBD, Ex-Servicemen and Sports persons reservations are 'horizontal' — they cut across vertical categories and the candidate is adjusted against the vertical reservation of the category to which he/she actually belongs.

### 2.2 Special Numerical Illustrations

Illustration A — Cadre of 1,000 DR posts on all-India open competition basis:

- Total reserved positions when the cadre is fully filled: SC 150, ST 75, OBC 270, EWS 100 (total 595).
- UR/General positions: 405.



- Within the 595 reserved, the 4% PwBD (40 positions) and 10% Ex-Servicemen (where applicable) are adjusted horizontally across SC/ST/OBC/EWS/UR depending on the social category of the PwBD or Ex-Serviceman candidate.

*[Source: Brochure on Reservation — Compendium of Instructions on Reservation in Appointments/Services updated 14.10.2022; consolidated vide O.M. dated 28.03.2024.]*

### 2.3 The "Own Merit" Principle (R.K. Sabharwal)

As held by the Supreme Court in *R.K. Sabharwal v. State of Punjab* (1995) 2 SCC 745, when a reserved-category candidate is selected on his own merit (without taking the benefit of any relaxation), he is to be counted against the unreserved/general category point on the roster, not against the reserved point. This judgement is the foundation of the present post-based reservation roster system prescribed in DoP&T O.M. dated 02.07.1997.

### 2.4 Promotion: Position under Article 16(4A) and 16(4B)

Reservation in promotion is available only to Scheduled Castes (15%) and Scheduled Tribes (7.5%) — not to OBCs, EWS, or other categories. The reservation operates through:

- Promotion by selection in Groups B, C and D, and from Group B to the lowest rung of Group A.
- Promotion through Limited Departmental Competitive Examination in Groups B, C and D.
- Promotion on the basis of seniority subject to fitness in all groups.

*[Source: Brochure on Reservation; reservation in promotion was upheld in M. Nagaraj v. Union of India (2006) 8 SCC 212 and further clarified in Jarnail Singh v. Lachhmi Narain Gupta (2018) 10 SCC 396, holding that the State need not collect quantifiable data of backwardness of SCs/STs, but must demonstrate inadequacy of representation.]*

**Exam Tip:** LDCE-IP is itself an LDCE governed by these rules — 15% SC and 7.5% ST reservation is applicable to the LDCE for Inspector Posts cadre as well. PwBD, EWS, OBC and Ex-Servicemen reservations do NOT apply to promotional examinations.

## Chapter 3 — Reservation in Promotion (SC/ST)

### 3.1 Modes of Promotion Reservation

Reservation in promotion is provided at 15% (SC) and 7.5% (ST) in respect of vacancies arising in promotional posts in the following modes:

4. Promotion by selection within Group B, C and D, and from Group B to the lowest rung of Group A.
5. Promotion through Limited Departmental Competitive Examination (LDCE) within Groups B, C and D.
6. Promotion on the basis of seniority subject to fitness in all Groups (A, B, C and D).

**No Reservation in Promotion:** (i) Promotion from the lowest rung of Group A to higher posts within Group A; (ii) Promotion to posts where DR is 100%; (iii) Promotion by selection within Group A above the lowest rung.

### 3.2 M. Nagaraj Conditions, As Revised by Jarnail Singh

In *M. Nagaraj v. Union of India* (2006), the Supreme Court held that the State, before making reservation in promotion in favour of SC/ST, must satisfy itself about (a) backwardness of the class, (b) inadequacy of representation in the cadre, and (c) administrative efficiency. In *Jarnail Singh v. Lachmi Narain Gupta* (2018), a five-judge Bench modified Nagaraj to the extent that no quantifiable data of backwardness of SCs/STs is required (since SCs/STs are deemed backward by virtue of their notification under Articles 341/342), but data on inadequacy of representation must still be collected.

### 3.3 Consequential Seniority

Under Article 16(4A) read with the Constitution (85th Amendment) Act, 2001, the seniority of a person promoted earlier by reason of the rule of reservation/roster shall not be disturbed when his junior in the feeder grade is later promoted to the same higher grade. This is termed "consequential seniority".

### 3.4 Promotion of SC/ST on Own Merit

As per DoP&T O.M. dated 10.08.2010, where an SC/ST candidate is found eligible for promotion in the general category on his own merit and without resort to any relaxed standards, he should not be counted against the reservation quota for SC/ST. The OM is presently sub judice before

the Supreme Court in SLP No. 30621/2011 (Jarnail Singh v. Lachhmi Narain Gupta), but until set aside, it continues to apply.

### 3.5 Latest Position — PwBD in Promotion

**DoP&T O.M. dated 09.10.2024:** Reservation in promotion to Persons with Benchmark Disabilities — grant of notional promotion w.e.f. 30.06.2016. PwBD employees who became eligible for benchmark-disability reservation in promotion (4%) from the date of the Supreme Court judgement in Siddaraju v. State of Karnataka shall be granted notional promotion from 30.06.2016, with actual financial benefit from the date the OM giving effect to Siddaraju takes effect.

*[Source: DoP&T O.M. dated 28.12.2023 (instructions on PwBD promotion reservation); DoP&T O.M. dated 09.10.2024 (notional promotion w.e.f. 30.06.2016).]*



## Chapter 4 — Reservation for OBCs and the Creamy Layer

### 4.1 The 27% OBC Reservation

Reservation for OBCs in direct recruitment to civil posts and services on all-India basis by open competition is at 27%, introduced w.e.f. 08.09.1993 pursuant to DoP&T O.M. No. 36012/22/93-Estt(SCT). For "otherwise than by open competition" mode, the percentage is 25.84%. There is no reservation for OBCs in promotion.

### 4.2 The Creamy Layer Concept

The benefit of OBC reservation is available only to non-creamy-layer OBC candidates. The "creamy layer" is defined by reference to the income/wealth and status of parents, as laid down in DoP&T O.M. No. 36012/22/93-Estt(SCT) dated 08.09.1993 (Schedule, Section 6) and revised from time to time.

#### *Income Ceiling for Creamy Layer (current)*

- The income ceiling for determining creamy layer status was last revised in 2017 to Rs. 8.00 lakh per annum (from Rs. 6.00 lakh).
- Income from salaries and agricultural income are excluded for this purpose.
- Children of holders of certain constitutional positions (President, V.P., Judges, etc.), Group A/Class I officers of the Central/State Government, and equivalent posts in PSUs/Banks fall in creamy layer regardless of income.

*[Source: DoP&T O.M. No. 36033/1/2013-Estt(Res) dated 13.09.2017 — revision of income limit from Rs. 6 lakh to Rs. 8 lakh p.a. The OBC creamy-layer certificate must be issued by competent authority and is valid for three financial years.]*

### 4.3 OBC Certificate — Authorities Competent to Issue

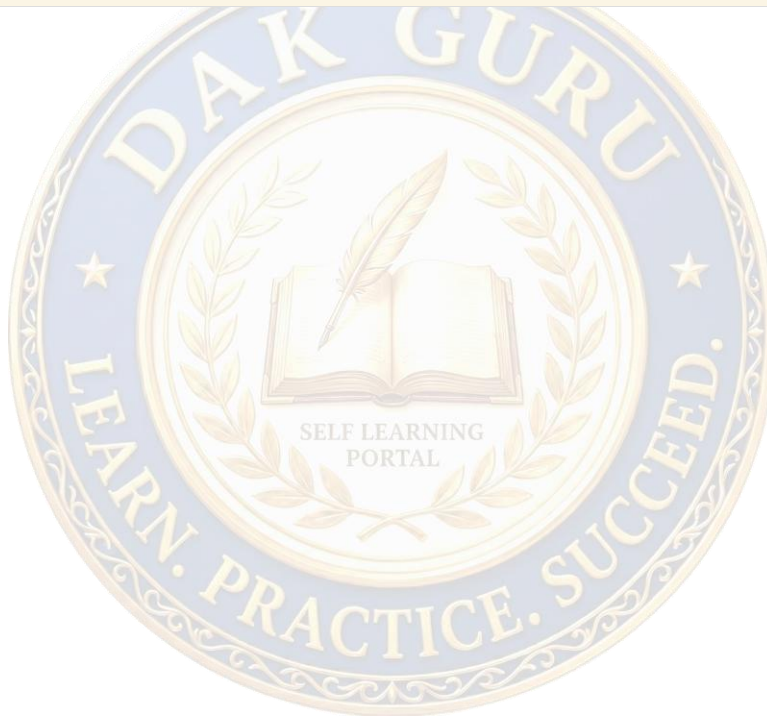
Pursuant to the Supreme Court direction in Kumari Madhuri Patil v. Addl. Commissioner (1994), DoP&T vide letter dated 15.03.2024 revised its instructions: the State Government / UT Administration shall now decide and notify the authorities competent to issue caste / community certificates. The format of OBC certificate is at Annexure II to the DoP&T O.M. No. 36036/2/2013-Estt(Res) dated 30.05.2014, with revisions; the Caste Certificate format has also been issued in Scheduled Languages vide DoP&T letter dated 13.04.2023.



#### 4.4 Sub-Categorization & Marathas

The Justice Rohini Commission was constituted on 02.10.2017 to examine sub-categorization within OBCs at the central level. The Commission has submitted its report but it has not yet been notified into the Central OBC List. Maratha reservation (16% in Maharashtra) was struck down by the Supreme Court in *Dr. Jaishri Laxmanrao Patil v. Chief Minister* (2021), but the State subsequently enacted fresh provisions which remain sub judice.

**Kerala HC Ruling on Hereditary Occupation:** Chandini C.K. v. State of Kerala (Kerala HC judgement dated 02.02.2024): the person concerned must be engaged or working as an artisan or in hereditary occupation to claim that exclusion; it is not enough that the father/ancestor was so engaged.



## Chapter 5 — Reservation for Economically Weaker Sections (EWS)

### 5.1 Constitutional & Statutory Basis

The 103rd Constitutional Amendment Act, 2019, inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) providing for up to 10% reservation in admissions to educational institutions and appointments in Government services for EWS of citizens (other than the classes mentioned in clauses (4) and (5) of Article 15 and Article 16(4)).

Operative instructions were issued vide DoP&T O.M. No. 36039/1/2019-Estt(Res) dated 31.01.2019, providing 10% reservation in direct recruitment to civil posts and services under the Central Government w.e.f. 01.02.2019.

### 5.2 Eligibility Criteria for EWS

A person who is not covered under the scheme of reservation for SCs, STs and OBCs and whose family has gross annual income below Rs. 8.00 lakh in the financial year preceding the year of application is to be identified as EWS, subject to the following exclusions on the basis of family assets (irrespective of family income):

- 5 acres of agricultural land and above;
- Residential flat of 1,000 sq. ft. and above;
- Residential plot of 100 sq. yards and above in notified municipalities; or
- Residential plot of 200 sq. yards and above in areas other than notified municipalities.

*[Source: DoP&T O.M. No. 36039/1/2019-Estt(Res) dated 31.01.2019; format of Income & Asset Certificate revised vide DoP&T letter dated 15.03.2024.]*

### 5.3 Issuing Authority for Income & Asset Certificate

As per the latest position (DoP&T letter dated 15.03.2024), the State Government / UT Administration shall notify the competent authority for issuance of Income & Asset Certificate. The certificate is in the format at the Annexure to the DoP&T O.M. dated 31.01.2019, with subsequent revisions.

### 5.4 Important Features of EWS Reservation

- EWS is over and above the existing 49.5% reservation for SC/ST/OBC.
- There is no creamy-layer concept applicable to EWS.
- EWS reservation is applicable to direct recruitment only — no reservation in promotion.

- No backlog or carry-forward for EWS vacancies.
- EWS reservation applies only at the entry level (initial recruitment).
- Constitutional validity upheld by the Constitution Bench in Janhit Abhiyan v. Union of India (2022) 7 SCC.

**Exam Tip:** Memorise: EWS = 10%, income ceiling Rs. 8 lakh, no creamy layer, no promotion reservation, no backlog. The OM date 31.01.2019 is a frequently asked one-liner.



## Chapter 6 — Reservation for Persons with Benchmark Disabilities (PwBDs)

### 6.1 The RPwD Act, 2016

The Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016 (came into force on 19.04.2017) increased reservation for Persons with Benchmark Disabilities from the earlier 3% (under PWD Act, 1995) to 4%, and expanded the categories of disability from three to four.

### 6.2 Categories and 1% Each

| Class | Disability Category                                                                                                                                                                | Percentage |
|-------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| (a)   | Blindness and Low Vision                                                                                                                                                           | 1%         |
| (b)   | Deaf and Hard of Hearing                                                                                                                                                           | 1%         |
| (c)   | Locomotor Disability including Cerebral Palsy, Leprosy Cured, Dwarfism, Acid Attack Victims and Muscular Dystrophy                                                                 | 1%         |
| (d)   | Autism, Intellectual Disability, Specific Learning Disability and Mental Illness; and Multiple Disabilities from amongst persons under clauses (a) to (d) including Deaf-Blindness | 1%         |
|       | TOTAL                                                                                                                                                                              | 4%         |

### 6.3 Benchmark Disability

A "person with benchmark disability" means a person with not less than 40% of a specified disability, where specified disability has not been defined in measurable terms, and includes a person with a disability where specified disability has been defined in measurable terms.

### 6.4 Identification of Posts and Reservation in Promotion

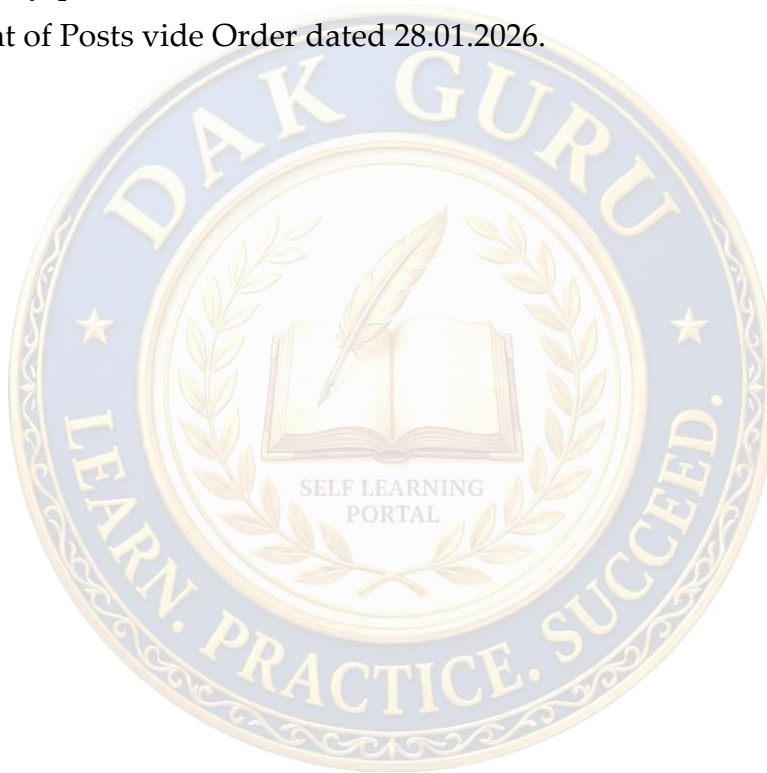
- Posts are identified as 'suitable' for PwBDs by an Expert Committee under the RPwD Act. Reservation is computed against the total number of vacancies in the cadre strength in each group of posts (including those identified for each category of disability).
- Reservation in promotion for PwBDs is also 4%, applicable to Group A and Group B posts to the extent identified.
- Notional promotion w.e.f. 30.06.2016 for PwBDs in promotion has been granted vide DoP&T O.M. dated 09.10.2024, following the Supreme Court's Siddharaju ruling.



*[Source: DoP&T O.M. dated 15.01.2018 (subsequent to RPwD Act); O.M. dated 17.05.2022 (consolidated PwBD reservation instructions); O.M. dated 28.12.2023 (PwBD promotion reservation); O.M. dated 09.10.2024 (notional promotion).]*

### 6.5 Age and Other Concessions

- Upper age relaxation of 10 years (general candidates), 13 years (OBC) and 15 years (SC/ST) for direct recruitment to Group C posts.
- Exemption from examination fee, reservation in training institutions, special leave to attend tournaments, and other ancillary benefits.
- Revised disability proforma under RPwD Amendment Rules, 2024 has been adopted by the Department of Posts vide Order dated 28.01.2026.



## Chapter 7 — Reservation for Ex-Servicemen

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### 7.1 The Statutory Framework

Reservation for Ex-servicemen in Central Civil Services and Posts is governed by the Ex-servicemen (Re-employment in Central Civil Services and Posts) Rules, 1979. The rules have been amended from time to time, most recently by DoP&T Notification dated 09.02.2026.

### 7.2 Percentage of Reservation

- Group C posts: 10% horizontal reservation.
- Group D (erstwhile, now MTS / Group C lowest) posts: 20% horizontal reservation.
- Group B posts (non-gazetted): 10% horizontal reservation.
- No reservation for Ex-servicemen in Group A posts and Gazetted Group B posts.

### 7.3 Concept of "Ex-Serviceman"

An ex-serviceman means a person who has served in any rank (whether as a combatant or non-combatant) in the regular Army, Navy or Air Force of the Indian Union, and (i) who retired from such service after earning his/her pension; or (ii) who has been released from such service on medical grounds attributable to military service or circumstances beyond his/her control and awarded medical or other disability pension; or (iii) who has been released, otherwise than on his/her own request, from such service as a result of reduction in establishment; or (iv) who has been released from such service after completing the specific period of engagement, otherwise than at his/her own request or by way of dismissal or discharge on account of misconduct or inefficiency, and has been given a gratuity.

### 7.4 Age and Educational Concessions

- Age relaxation: Period of military service rendered + 3 years; for SC/ST ex-servicemen the maximum relaxation extends further by 5 years.
- Educational concession: in lower grades, defence service may be treated as equivalent to specified educational qualification.
- Reservation is to be granted only against vacancies in identified posts. The candidate must apply within the eligibility period from date of discharge.

## 7.5 Latest Updates

**Compendium 25.12.2025:** DoP&T O.M. dated 25.12.2025 issued the Compendium of Guidelines on Reservation for Ex-Servicemen — a single consolidated document covering all instructions issued from time to time.

**Amendment 09.02.2026:** DoP&T Notification dated 09.02.2026 — amendment in Rule 2 of the Ex-servicemen (Re-employment in Central Civil Services and Posts) Rules, 1979 (redefining categories of ex-servicemen).



## Chapter 8 — Roster System (Post-Based Rosters)

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### 8.1 Migration from Vacancy-Based to Post-Based Roster

Pursuant to the Supreme Court's decision in R.K. Sabharwal v. State of Punjab (1995) 2 SCC 745, DoP&T vide O.M. No. 36012/2/96-Estt(Res) dated 02.07.1997 prescribed the post-based reservation roster, replacing the earlier 100-point vacancy-based roster. The new system operates by earmarking reserved slots against specific posts in the cadre rather than against vacancies.

### 8.2 Cycle of Earmarking

The earmarking of reserved posts is done by applying the prescribed percentages to the cadre strength. Once all reserved slots are filled by their respective categories, further vacancies arising in the cadre revert to the category that vacated them. Model rosters of various cadre strengths have been prescribed by DoP&T.

### 8.3 Backlog Reserved Vacancies

Backlog reserved vacancies are those reserved vacancies which could not be filled in spite of best efforts in the year in which they arose and the next year. Such vacancies do not count against the 50% ceiling (Article 16(4B) of the Constitution) and are treated as a separate group of vacancies. They retain their reserved character indefinitely.

*[Source: DoP&T O.M. dated 02.07.1997 (post-based rosters); O.M. dated 14.09.1999 and subsequent OMs on calculation of backlog.]*

### 8.4 Maintenance and Inspection of Rosters

- The appointing authority shall maintain separate post-based rosters for each cadre and update them after every recruitment cycle.
- The Liaison Officer of the Ministry/Department is responsible for ensuring proper maintenance of rosters.
- Rosters are subject to inspection by Officers of the National Commissions for SC/ST/Backward Classes.



## Chapter 9 — Caste/Income Certificates and Verification

### 9.1 Authority Competent to Issue

Pursuant to the Supreme Court's judgement in Kumari Madhuri Patil v. Addl. Commissioner (1994) 6 SCC 241 and consequent DoP&T O.M. No. 36011/1/2012-Estt(Res-I) dated 30.05.2014 read with the subsequent revision vide DoP&T letter No. 36039/1/2019-Estt(Res-II) dated 15.03.2024, the responsibility for issue and verification of caste / community / tribe certificate lies with the concerned State Government / UT Administration. The State / UT shall upload on its website the details of the authorities competent to issue such certificates.

### 9.2 Format of Certificates

- Annexure I — Caste/Tribe Certificate (SC/ST)
- Annexure II — Community Certificate (OBC) with non-creamy layer declaration
- Annexure (separate) — Income & Asset Certificate (EWS)
- Scheduled Languages — Caste Certificate format also notified in Scheduled Languages vide DoP&T letter dated 13.04.2023.

### 9.3 Action against Fake/False Caste Certificates

As per DoP&T O.M. dated 10.01.2013 read with O.M. dated 09.05.2018, services of any Government servant who is found to have got appointment on the basis of a fake/false caste certificate shall be terminated forthwith following the procedure laid down in the relevant Service Rules. The appointment is rendered void ab initio. Departmental Promotion Committees / Vigilance proceedings are to be initiated.

**Madhuri Patil Principles:** (i) Caste Scrutiny Committee may verify; (ii) interim relief should not be granted in writ jurisdiction; (iii) order of cancellation operates retrospectively; (iv) cancellation of caste certificate has the effect of automatic termination of service without further inquiry.

### 9.4 Production of Certificate

- Candidates claiming reservation must produce the caste/community/income certificate on the prescribed date (date of application / last date of receipt of applications / date of interview, as specified in the recruitment notification).

- Application of OBC candidates is to be considered without insisting on the non-creamy-layer declaration at the time of application — only at the time of appointment is the certificate verified by the competent authority.



## Chapter 10 — De-reservation, Backlog & Special Recruitment Drives

### 10.1 De-reservation: General Bar

As per DoP&T policy, a reserved vacancy cannot be de-reserved as a matter of routine. The DoP&T does not encourage de-reservation. Before sending a proposal for de-reservation, the Ministry/Department is advised to:

- Explore the possibility of filling up the reserved vacancy by other modes of recruitment available under the Recruitment Rules;
- Re-advertise the vacancy, if not filled in the first attempt;
- Continue carry-forward of the vacancy for three years subject to the 50% ceiling in any one year.

**Authority for De-Reservation:** Approval for de-reservation rests with the DoP&T in respect of reserved vacancies for SC/ST/OBC. A proposal duly cleared by the administrative Ministry must be sent with full justification, certificate of having explored all alternative modes, and concurrence of the National Commission concerned.

### 10.2 Backlog and Carry-Forward

Vacancies reserved for SC/ST/OBC which remain unfilled in a particular year may be carried forward to the next year. If still unfilled, they are treated as backlog reserved vacancies and:

- Are kept outside the 50% ceiling for the year in which they are eventually filled (Article 16(4B));
- Retain their reserved character indefinitely;
- Are filled through Special Recruitment Drives.

### 10.3 Special Recruitment Drives

Special Recruitment Drives are launched from time to time to clear backlog reserved vacancies. The relevant procedures are laid down in DoP&T O.M. No. 36038/1/2008-Estt(Res) and subsequent updates. The most recent comprehensive Special Recruitment Drive was launched in 2008 and is reviewed periodically.

## Chapter 11 — Liaison Officers & Reservation Cell

### 11.1 Constitution

Every Ministry/Department is required to appoint a Liaison Officer (LO) for SC/ST/OBC/PwBD/EWS and Ex-Servicemen reservation matters. The LO is to be of the rank of Deputy Secretary or above, and his/her duties are spelt out in the standing OMs of DoP&T including the recent OM dated 08.12.2022.

### 11.2 Duties of the Liaison Officer

- Ensure proper implementation of reservation orders in the Ministry/Department and its attached/subordinate offices.
- Maintain reservation register/roster register and have it inspected periodically.
- Ensure adherence by recruiting agencies (UPSC/SSC/RRB) and submit annual reports to DoP&T.
- Handle grievances and complaints from SC/ST/OBC/PwBD/EWS candidates and employees.
- Liaise with the National Commissions for SCs/STs/Backward Classes/PwDs.

### 11.3 Training of Liaison Officers

**DoP&T O.M. dated 22.10.2024:** Training of Liaison Officers by Institute of Secretariat Training & Management (ISTM) and through the modules available on the iGOT Karmayogi platform. All LOs must complete the prescribed module within the timelines notified.

### 11.4 Reservation Cell

A separate Reservation Cell under the LO is to be set up in every Ministry/Department to assist the LO in enforcement of reservation. The Cell is responsible for maintenance of the reservation roster, monitoring vacancies, processing reservation-related grievances, and preparing annual statistics.

*[Source: DoP&T O.M. dated 08.12.2022 — Liaison Officer for SC/ST/OBC/PwD/EWS & ESM and Reservation Cell for enforcement of reservation.]*



## PART II

### SPORTS PERSONS RESERVATION

*Recruitment of Meritorious Sportspersons in Government Service*



## Chapter 12 — DoP&T Consolidated Instructions dated 04.03.2024

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### 12.1 The Single Authoritative Document

All earlier OMs of DoP&T on recruitment and promotion of sportspersons have now been consolidated into a single comprehensive document issued vide DoP&T O.M. No. DOPT-1711450898768 dated 04.03.2024 (also referred to as O.M. No. 14034/1/2020-Pers. Policy (D) Pt. Vol.II dated 4th March, 2024). This document supersedes the need to refer to old OMs issued from time to time, though the list of such superseded OMs is given in the Appendix to that document.

### 12.2 Genesis of the Scheme

The scheme for recruitment of meritorious sportspersons in Central Government services was originally introduced vide DoP&T O.M. No. 14015/1/76-Estt(D) dated 04.08.1980, which has since been amended and consolidated multiple times — notably vide O.M. dated 04.05.1995, dated 03.10.2013, dated 18.11.2022, and most recently dated 04.03.2024.

### 12.3 Objectives of the Scheme

- To provide employment opportunities to meritorious sportspersons in recognition of their excellence in sports;
- To encourage participation in sports and games at higher levels;
- To provide a secure career for sportspersons who may otherwise have limited employment prospects after their active sporting career;
- To promote sports culture within the government service.

### 12.4 Two Distinct Schemes

The DoP&T O.M. dated 04.03.2024 covers two distinct schemes:

7. Scheme A — Recruitment of Meritorious Sportspersons (in relaxation of recruitment procedure, against direct recruitment vacancies); and
8. Scheme B — Out-of-Turn Promotion for Sportspersons (for excellence in sports events, by upgradation of post personal to the sportsperson).

## Chapter 13 — Eligibility, Order of Preference & Authorities

### 13.1 Posts to Which Applicable

- Appointment of meritorious sportspersons can be made to any post in Group C or erstwhile Group D, which under the Recruitment Rules is to be filled by direct recruitment, otherwise than through UPSC.
- No such appointment shall be made to any post in Group A or Group B by direct recruitment.
- A meritorious sportsperson can be considered for appointment notwithstanding the fact that he is already in service of the Government (subject to no objection from existing employer).
- In making promotions, no preference shall be given to meritorious sportspersons on the basis of sports alone, though that fact may be taken into consideration in assessing the overall merit (Para 2 of DoP&T O.M. dated 04.08.1980).

### 13.2 Eligibility Criteria (Categories of Sportspersons)

As per the consolidated instructions dated 04.03.2024, appointments under these orders can be made of sportspersons considered meritorious with reference to the following criteria:

| S. No. | Eligibility Criterion                                                                                                                                                                                |
|--------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| (i)    | Sportspersons who have represented a State or the Country in National or International competition                                                                                                   |
| (ii)   | Medal winners in Junior National Championships                                                                                                                                                       |
| (iii)  | Medal winners in Khelo India Youth Games (age category above 18 years)                                                                                                                               |
| (iv)   | Medal winners in Khelo India Winter Games                                                                                                                                                            |
| (v)    | Medal winners in Khelo India Para Games                                                                                                                                                              |
| (vi)   | Medal winners in Khelo India University Games                                                                                                                                                        |
| (vii)  | Medal winners in School Games Federation of India (SGFI) in any of the games/sports listed in the instructions                                                                                       |
| (viii) | For Chess: Grand Master (GM) Title, International Master (IM) Title, Chess Olympiad. IM/GM title should be in Open Category (Woman Grandmaster etc.). National Open Chess Championship is treated as |

| S. No. | Eligibility Criterion                                                                                  |
|--------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|        | National Championships; medal-winning performance in National Team Chess Championship also considered. |

### 13.3 Order of Preference

Where eligible candidates exceed the number of vacancies, the selection committee is to follow the following order of preference (Para VI of OM dated 04.03.2024):

9. First Preference — Candidates who have represented the country in an International Competition with the clearance of the Department of Sports, Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports.
10. Second Preference — Those who have represented a State/UT in the Senior or Junior level National Championships organised by the National Sports Federations recognised by Department of Sports, MoYAS, or National Games organised by Indian Olympic Association, and have won medals or positions up to 3rd place. Between Senior and Junior National Championships, the candidate having participated and won medal in Senior National Championship is given preference.
11. Third Preference — Those who have represented a University in an Inter-University competition conducted by Association of Indian Universities / Inter-University Sports Board, or Khelo India University Games conducted with authorisation of Department of Sports, MoYAS, and have won medals or positions up to 3rd place in finals.
12. Fourth Preference — Those who have represented a State/UT in Khelo India Youth Games (age category above 18 years), or Khelo India Winter Games, or Khelo India Para Games conducted with authorisation of Department of Sports, MoYAS, and have won medals or positions up to 3rd place.

### 13.4 List of Sports Disciplines (65 Sports)

As per DoP&T O.M. No. DOPT-1668767575965 dated 18.11.2022 (continued by the OM dated 04.03.2024), the list of 65 sports disciplines is explicitly notified. All meritorious sportspersons belonging to these 65 disciplines qualify for recruitment under sports quota. Some major disciplines:

- Aquatics (Swimming, Diving, Water Polo, etc.)
- Archery, Athletics, Badminton, Basketball, Boxing, Cricket



- Chess (with special IM/GM provisions), Cycling, Equestrian
- Fencing, Football, Golf, Gymnastics, Handball
- Hockey, Judo, Kabaddi, Kho-Kho, Polo
- Rowing, Sailing, Shooting, Squash, Table Tennis
- Taekwondo, Tennis, Volleyball, Weightlifting, Wrestling, Yachting
- Para-sports (multiple disciplines), and others as notified.

**Important:** CBDT clarification dated 22.02.2023 expressly stated: there is no provision, for any reason, to restrict sports quota recruitment to particular sports discipline(s) from the list available in the DoP&T instructions. CCAs / Zones must fill up vacancies in strict compliance with DoP&T instructions without any deviation.

### 13.5 Authorities Competent to Award Certificates

The authority competent to award eligibility certificates is specified in the OM as follows:

- International Competitions — Secretary, Department of Sports, Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports, Government of India.
- National Championships organised by National Sports Federations / Games organised by IOA — Secretary of the National Sports Federation recognised by Department of Sports.
- Inter-University tournaments — Director, Association of Indian Universities / Inter-University Sports Board.
- State/UT level — Director of Sports of the concerned State/UT.
- Khelo India Games — Secretary, Department of Sports.

## Chapter 14 — Recruitment Procedure & Out-of-Turn Promotion

### 14.1 Procedure for Recruitment

- All recruitment of sports persons shall be made only by advertisement of vacancies in Employment News and not by inviting names from any other source.
- An application received by the appointing authority or a higher authority from a sportsperson belonging to any of the categories mentioned in the eligibility criteria shall be considered.
- A Selection Committee, to be constituted by the appointing authority, shall consider the applications. The Committee shall include a representative of the Sports Authority of India / Department of Sports.
- Selection shall be made strictly in accordance with the order of preference given in the instructions.
- Trade test / typing test, where applicable under Recruitment Rules, may be waived/relaxed in deserving cases by the appointing authority.

### 14.2 Relaxation in Age Limit

Categories of sportspersons specified in para A.I.(a) of the consolidated instructions are allowed relaxation in upper age limit:

- Up to 5 years (general category)
- Up to 10 years (in case of those belonging to Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes)
- This concession is available only to sportspersons who satisfy all other eligibility conditions relating to educational qualifications etc. and furnish a certificate in the prescribed form.

### 14.3 Adjustment Against Reservation Roster

**Crucial Point:** A sportsperson appointed against sports quota is to be adjusted against the appropriate vertical reservation roster point of the category (SC/ST/OBC/EWS/UR) to which he/she belongs. A sportsperson from SC category will be counted against the SC reservation point; from OBC against OBC point; from UR against the General category vacancy point. Sports quota is HORIZONTAL, not vertical.

#### 14.4 Scheme for Out-of-Turn Promotion

Section B of the DoP&T OM dated 04.03.2024 deals with the scheme for Out-of-Turn Promotion (OTP) for serving sportspersons:

##### *Objective*

- To promote a sportsperson for excellence in sports events by upgradation of the post personal to the sportsperson till it is vacated by the sportsperson concerned (by retirement, transfer, etc.).

##### *Eligibility Criteria for OTP*

- Winning a medal in international/national level events identified in the scheme.
- Performance in events held during the calendar year/sports season.
- Number of OTPs is limited (typically one or two during the entire career of the sportsperson).

##### *Procedure for OTP*

- Recommendation by the Department of Sports.
- Constitution of a Departmental Promotion Committee for the purpose.
- Upgradation of post is personal to the sportsperson and does not affect the cadre strength.

#### 14.5 Ceiling on Recruitment

Para III of the consolidated instructions limits the number of meritorious sportspersons recruited in any year to a ceiling fixed by the Ministry/Department, which is typically 5% of the Group C / erstwhile Group D vacancies in a year. The Department of Posts has fixed this ceiling at 5% of vacancies in Direct Recruitment Quota in Group C posts (PA/SA, Postman/Mail Guard, MTS).

## Chapter 15 — Other Incentives (Increments, Casual Leave, TA/DA)

### 15.1 Special Increment as Personal Pay

Separate updated instructions on incentives have been issued by Estt.(Pay) Division of DoP&T as on 15.09.2022, covering Special Increment (Personal Pay), Special Casual Leave, periods treated as on duty, TA/DA, and revised rates of Special Increment.

### 15.2 Special Casual Leave

- Special Casual Leave (SCL) up to 30 days in a calendar year is admissible to a sportsperson for participation in sporting events / training camps / pre-participation training etc. duly authorised by the Department of Sports.
- SCL beyond 30 days in a calendar year may be granted by the Head of Department on the merits of each case.

### 15.3 Periods Treated as On Duty

- Period of participation in tournaments of national or international importance, including pre-participation training and travel time, may be treated as on duty.
- The sportsperson is entitled to TA/DA at the rates admissible to him/her on tour, subject to non-receipt of equivalent amount from the sports federation/government.

### 15.4 Revised Rates of Special Increment (Personal Pay)

| Achievement Level                                                                | No. of Special Increments |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| Gold Medal in Olympics / Paralympics / Deaflympics                               | Five                      |
| Silver Medal in Olympics / Paralympics / Deaflympics                             | Four                      |
| Bronze Medal in Olympics / Paralympics / Deaflympics                             | Three                     |
| Gold Medal in World Cup / World Championships / Asian Games / Commonwealth Games | Three                     |
| Silver Medal in the above events                                                 | Two                       |
| Bronze Medal in the above events / participation in Olympics without medal       | One                       |
| Gold Medal in Senior National Championship                                       | One                       |



*[Source: DoP&T (Estt. Pay) instructions dated 15.09.2022 — revised rates of Special Increment (Personal Pay) for meritorious sportspersons.]*

### 15.5 Other Benefits

- Reimbursement of fees for participation in tournaments.
- Sports kit allowance (where admissible).
- Cash awards for outstanding performance (administered by Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports through Khel Ratna and other schemes).



## Chapter 16 — Sports Quota in Department of Posts

### 16.1 Notification Framework

The Department of Posts implements the sports quota policy by issuing periodic notifications inviting applications from meritorious sportspersons for direct recruitment to Postal Assistant/Sorting Assistant, Postman/Mail Guard and Multi-Tasking Staff cadres. The most recent comprehensive notification was issued vide letter No. W-17/55/2022-SPN-I dated 08.11.2023, with addenda/corrigenda dated 10.01.2024.

### 16.2 Cadres Covered & Vacancies (illustrative — 2023 cycle)

| Cadre                                        | Pay Level                   | Educational Qualification                                               | Age Limit   |
|----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Postal Assistant / Sorting Assistant (PA/SA) | Level-4 (Rs. 25,500–81,100) | Bachelor's degree + Computer knowledge                                  | 18–27 years |
| Postman / Mail Guard                         | Level-3 (Rs. 21,700–69,100) | 12th pass + local language + Computer; 2-wheeler licence (Postman only) | 18–27 years |
| Multi-Tasking Staff (MTS)                    | Level-1 (Rs. 18,000–56,900) | 10th pass                                                               | 18–25 years |

**PwBD Exemption (DoP):** Persons with Benchmark Disability are exempted from the requirement of possessing a valid 2-wheeler / LMV licence for the post of Postman / Mail Guard.

### 16.3 Application & Selection Process (DoP)

- Application: only online, through [dopsportsrecruitment.cept.gov.in](https://dopsportsrecruitment.cept.gov.in).
- Candidate gives order of preference for both cadre and postal circle.
- Application fee: Rs. 100 (General/OBC); SC/ST/PwBD/Women/Ex-Servicemen exempted.
- Selection by the Sports Recruitment Online Portal — automated shortlisting strictly on the basis of the four-tier order of preference.

- Form-I certificate (representing the country in an International Competition) must be uploaded online and verified from the issuing authority.
- Essential educational qualification certificates also verified from the prescribed authority.
- Candidates are allotted to Divisions/Units based on preference and availability of vacancies.

#### 16.4 Selection on Form-I and Order of Preference (DoP Practice)

- Recruitment is made on the basis of online application and uploaded Form-I (sports certificate) — no physical sports trial.
- First Preference: Form-I represents country in International Competition. Second to Fourth Preferences as per DoP&T order.
- Within the same preference level, the Senior National Championship medal-winners are given preference over Junior National Championship medal-winners.

#### 16.5 Ceiling on Sports Quota Recruitment in DoP

**DoP Ceiling:** The Department of Posts utilises up to 5% of vacancies in Direct Recruitment quota in Group C posts for sports quota. This 5% is HORIZONTAL — sports persons are adjusted against the SC/ST/OBC/EWS/UR vertical reservation roster point of the category to which they belong.

*[Source: DoP letter No. W-17/55/2022-SPN-I dated 08.11.2023; recent provisional appointment lists (Tamil Nadu Circle dated 22.08.2025 and subsequent corrigenda) confirm the procedural framework.]*

#### 16.6 Recent DoP Sports Quota Activity

- Sports Quota Notification 2023: 1,899 vacancies advertised across all circles (PA/SA, Postman/Mail Guard, MTS).
- Online portal: [dopsportsrecruitment.cept.gov.in](https://dopsportsrecruitment.cept.gov.in) (CEPT Mysore-managed).
- Latest result/provisional list activity: Tamil Nadu Circle Second Provisional List (in continuation of memo dated 22.08.2025) — based on Form-I verification and educational qualification.

PART III

**COMPASSIONATE APPOINTMENT**

*DoP&T Master Circular 02.08.2022 & DoP RMPS-2022*





## Chapter 17 — DoP&T Master Circular dated 02.08.2022 — Scheme

### 17.1 Background and Genesis

The Scheme for Compassionate Appointment under the Central Government has been in existence since 1958 in some form. The first consolidated instructions were issued by the Ministry of Home Affairs vide O.M. dated 27.03.1958. The Scheme has since been reviewed and revised periodically. The currently operative comprehensive instructions are contained in DoP&T O.M. No. 14014/02/2012-Estt.(D) dated 16.01.2013, as updated by various subsequent OMs.

**Master Circular:** DoP&T O.M. No. 14014/1/2022-Estt.(D) dated 02.08.2022 (also bearing reference No. DOPT-1667555281194) is the latest Master Circular consolidating all instructions on the Scheme for Compassionate Appointment under the Central Government. It supersedes the earlier consolidations for ready reference.

### 17.2 Object of the Scheme

The object of the Scheme is to grant appointment on compassionate grounds to a dependent family member of:

- A Government servant who dies while in service (including death by suicide); or
- A Government servant who is retired on medical grounds under Rule 2 of CCS (Medical Examination) Rules 1957 or the corresponding provision in the Central Civil Service Regulations before attaining the age of 55 years (57 years for erstwhile Group D Government servants); or
- A member of the Armed Forces who dies during service or is invalided out before the age of retirement.

The purpose is to relieve the family of the deceased / medically retired Government servant from financial destitution and to help it get over the emergency. It is not a vested right or hereditary claim to employment in Government service.

### 17.3 Authority to Make Compassionate Appointment

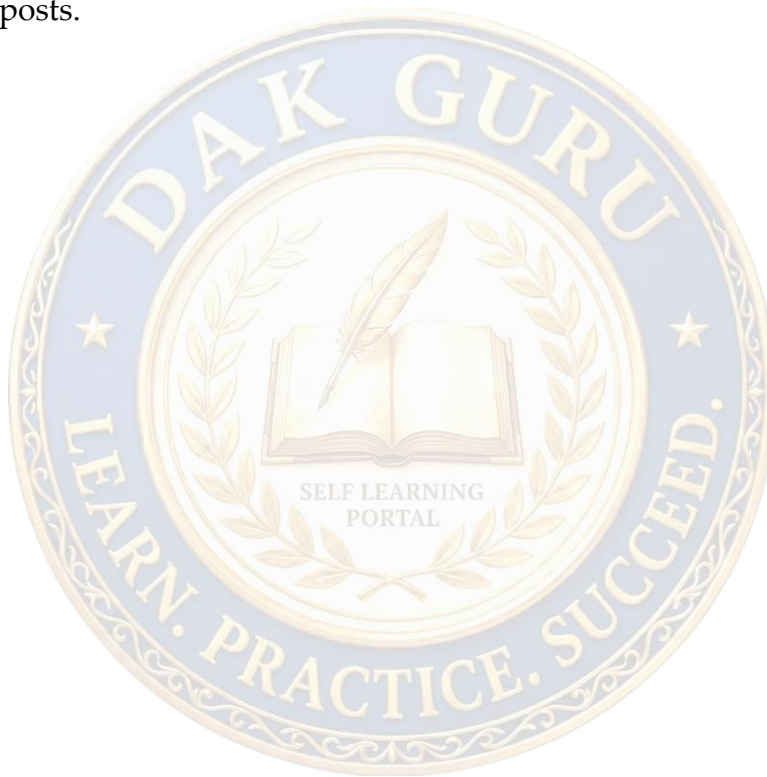
The Secretary in the Ministry/Department is the appointing authority for compassionate appointment in respect of all posts in the Ministry/Department and its attached/subordinate offices. For Group C posts, the power may be delegated to the Heads of Departments/Heads of Offices.

In the Department of Posts, the structure is:

- Postal Directorate Level: Secretary (Posts) is the competent authority.
- Circle Level: Chief Postmaster General is the appointing authority for posts in the Circle.
- Circle Relaxation Committee (CRC): Considers cases of compassionate appointment for posts at Circle level.

#### **17.4 Posts Available**

Compassionate appointment can be made to any Group C post (including erstwhile Group D, now subsumed in MTS Level-1). No compassionate appointment is permitted in Group A or Group B (gazetted) posts.



## Chapter 18 — Eligibility, Definitions & Dependents

### 18.1 Who is "Government Servant"

For the purpose of compassionate appointment, the term "Government Servant" means a Government servant appointed on regular basis (i.e., not on contract, casual, daily wage, work-charged or ad-hoc basis) and not a re-employed pensioner. It includes a Government servant on whose death/medical retirement, the family becomes indigent and is left without means of livelihood.

### 18.2 Definition of "Dependent Family Member"

As per Para 4 of the DoP&T Master Circular dated 02.08.2022, "dependent family member" means:

- Spouse of the deceased / medically-retired Government servant; or
- Son (including legally adopted son); or
- Daughter (including legally adopted daughter); or
- Brother or sister, in the case of unmarried Government servant or in case the spouse has predeceased the Government servant — provided the brother / sister was wholly dependent on the Government servant at the time of his / her death or retirement on medical grounds.

### 18.3 Married Son — Eligibility

**Important Clarification:** DoP&T O.M. dated 05.09.2016 reviewed FAQs of 30.05.2013/25.02.2015 with regard to married sons. As per current position, a married son is eligible for compassionate appointment provided he satisfies all other conditions including financial indigency and consent of other dependent family members.

### 18.4 Children of Void Marriage

**Supreme Court Ruling:** The Supreme Court has held that children of a void marriage are legitimate offspring and cannot be denied the benefits of compassionate appointment (referred in DoP&T OM and noted in dtf.in compilation of compassionate appointment orders).

### 18.5 "Indigent Family" — The Crucial Test

The dependent family must be in indigent condition / financial penury. Indigency is to be assessed by reference to:

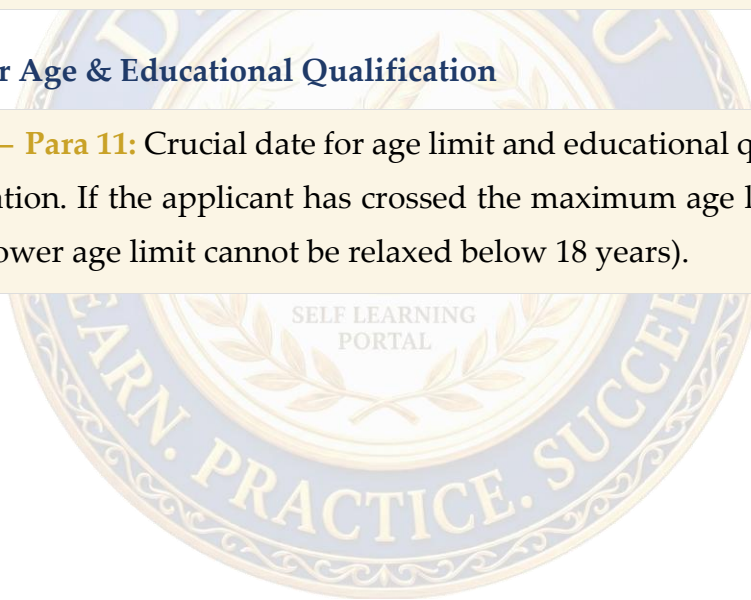
- Family pension and other terminal benefits available to the family;
- Movable and immovable assets owned by the family;
- Number of dependents and their educational/marital status;
- Income from other sources, including employment of any other family member.

### 18.6 Cut-off Date for Assessing Indigency

**DoP RMPS-2022 — Para 3:** Cut-off date for working out the indigency of the dependent family of the deceased employee is the date of death or date of retirement on medical grounds — NOT the date of consideration by CRC.

### 18.7 Crucial Date for Age & Educational Qualification

**DoP RMPS-2022 — Para 11:** Crucial date for age limit and educational qualification shall be the date of application. If the applicant has crossed the maximum age limit, age relaxation will be required (lower age limit cannot be relaxed below 18 years).



## Chapter 19 — The 5% Ceiling, Vacancy Calculation & Authority

### 19.1 The 5% Vacancy Ceiling

**Cardinal Rule:** Compassionate appointments can be made up to a maximum of 5% of vacancies falling under Direct Recruitment Quota in any Group C post. The appointing authority may hold back up to 5% of vacancies in the said categories from being filled by direct recruitment (through SSC or otherwise) to be available for compassionate appointment.

*[Source: Para 6(b) of DoP&T Master Circular dated 02.08.2022.]*

### 19.2 Adjustment Against Recruitment Roster

A person selected for appointment on compassionate grounds should be adjusted in the recruitment roster against the appropriate category — SC / ST / OBC / EWS / General — depending upon the category to which he belongs. For example:

- Belongs to SC → adjusted against the SC reservation point on the roster;
- Belongs to ST → adjusted against the ST point;
- Belongs to OBC → adjusted against OBC point;
- Belongs to General → adjusted against the General/UR point.

### 19.3 Fractional Vacancies

For the purpose of calculation of vacancies for compassionate appointment, a fraction of a vacancy either half or exceeding half but less than one may be taken as one vacancy.

*[Source: Para 2 and 3 of O.M. No. 14014/24/1999-Estt(D) dated 28.12.1999, as incorporated in Master Circular dated 02.08.2022.]*

### 19.4 Liberalised Method for Small Ministries/Departments

Small Ministries/Departments are those organisations where no vacancy for compassionate appointment could be located under the 5% quota for the last 3 years. Such Ministries/Departments may add up the total of DR vacancies in Group C and erstwhile Group D posts (excluding technical posts) arising in each year for 3 or more preceding years and calculate 5% of the grand total of vacancies of such years to locate one vacancy for compassionate appointment.

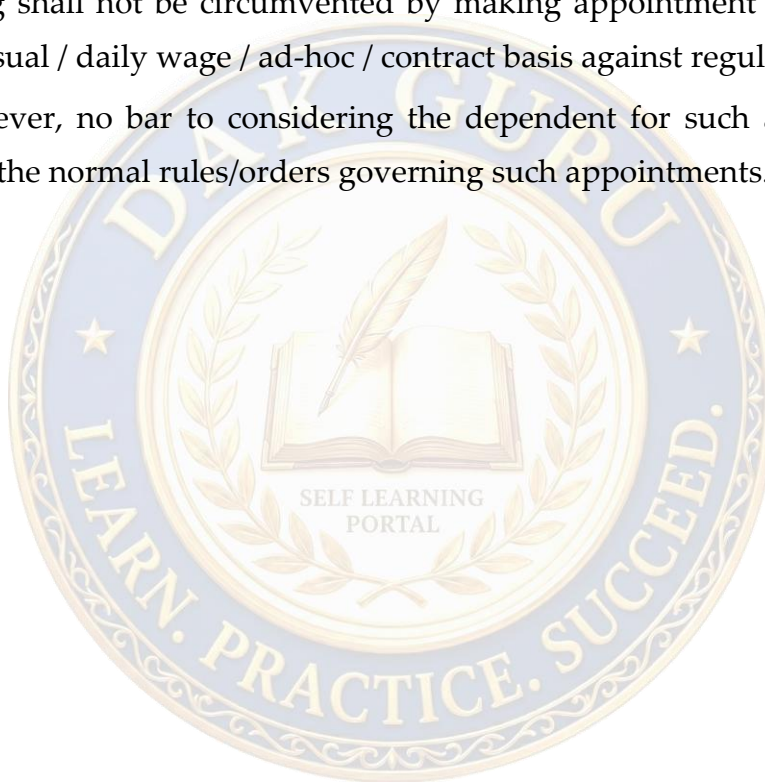


### 19.5 Grouping of Posts for Small Offices

Group C posts in which there are less than 20 direct recruitment vacancies in a recruitment year may be grouped together, and out of the total number of vacancies, 5% may be filled on compassionate grounds, subject to the condition that compassionate appointment shall be made only in posts of the same status (i.e., similar pay level and recruitment grade).

### 19.6 No Circumvention of the 5% Ceiling

- The 5% ceiling for compassionate appointment shall NOT be exceeded by utilising any other vacancy (e.g., sports quota vacancy).
- The 5% ceiling shall not be circumvented by making appointment of dependent family member on casual / daily wage / ad-hoc / contract basis against regular vacancies.
- There is, however, no bar to considering the dependent for such appointment if he is eligible as per the normal rules/orders governing such appointments.



## Chapter 20 — Procedure & Documentation

### 20.1 Application

The dependent family member desirous of seeking compassionate appointment is to submit a written request in the prescribed Proforma 'A' (Application), Proforma 'B' (Family Particulars), and Proforma 'C' (Financial Status). The application is to be supported by:

- Death certificate of the deceased Government servant / medical board certificate in case of medical retirement;
- Death/discharge certificate;
- No-objection certificate (NOC) from other adult dependent family members in favour of the applicant;
- Income certificate of all family members;
- Educational and age proof of the applicant;
- Caste/community/disability certificate (if applicable);
- Affidavit declaring family particulars and financial status.

### 20.2 Constitution of the Committee

A Committee of three officers is constituted to consider requests for compassionate appointment. The Committee:

- Examines the indigent condition of the family;
- Considers the financial position with reference to family pension, terminal benefits and other sources;
- Awards Relative Merit Points to the applicant;
- Makes a recommendation to the competent authority.

In the Department of Posts, the Committee is called the Circle Relaxation Committee (CRC) and is constituted in each Circle.

### 20.3 Procedural Rules — DoP&T Replacement of Para 13 (23.08.2021)

**DoP&T O.M. dated 23.08.2021:** Consolidated instructions on compassionate appointment — Replacement of Para 13 (regarding Procedure). This OM revised the procedural framework and reiterated the use of a 100-point Relative Merit Point System for objective assessment.

## 20.4 Limitation on Recommendation

The Committee constituted for considering a request for compassionate appointment should limit its recommendation to appointment only in a really deserving case, and only if a vacancy meant for compassionate appointment will be available within a year in the concerned administrative Ministry / Department / Office, and that too within the ceiling of 5% of DR vacancies in Group C posts.

*[Source: Para 6(e) of Master Circular dated 02.08.2022; based on O.M. No. 14014/18/2000-Estt(D) dated 22.06.2001.]*

## 20.5 Voluntary Disclosure

**Transparency Requirement:** DoP&T O.M. dated 20.05.2019 — Concerned Ministries/Departments are required to voluntarily disclose information relating to compassionate appointment on their official website, including: (a) names of applicants under consideration; (b) date of receipt of application; (c) status of each case; (d) decisions taken.

## 20.6 Time Limit

Earlier, there was a five-year time limit for making the application from the date of death/medical retirement. This has been relaxed: applications can now be considered without any time limit, though belated cases (more than 5 years old) are subjected to reduced weightage and additional scrutiny.

## 20.7 Maintenance Undertaking

A person appointed on compassionate grounds is required to give a written undertaking that he will maintain properly the other family members who were dependent on the Government servant. If, at any subsequent point, it is proved that the family members are being neglected or are not being maintained properly, the appointment may be terminated forthwith. This undertaking has been examined for legal enforceability in consultation with the Ministry of Law and is incorporated as a condition of appointment.

## Chapter 21 — Department of Posts — RMPS-2022

### 21.1 Issuance

The Department of Posts issued the Revised Relative Merit Points System (RMPS-2022) vide letter No. 17-1/2022-SPG-II dated 23.03.2022. This RMPS-2022 superseded the earlier RMPS-2020 (issued vide letter No. 17-4/2018-SPG-II dated 28.09.2020) which in turn had superseded the earliest RMPS dated 20.01.2010 (letter No. 37-36/2004-SPB-I/C). The revision was made keeping in view DoP&T O.M. No. 43019/9/2019-Estt(D) dated 23.08.2021.

### 21.2 Key Features of RMPS-2022

- 100-Point Scale + 15 Bonus Points: The revised RMP is based on 100 points across 10 variables, with provision for additional maximum 15 bonus points for the widow of the deceased employee / wife of an employee retired on medical grounds.
- Cut-off Date for Indigency: Date of death / date of retirement on medical grounds (Para 3).
- Cases to be Considered by CRC: All cases of death/retirement on medical grounds till 31 December of the year, along with cases referred by previous CRC (Para 4).
- Three-Time Rule: A case shall be considered three times continuously in a row. If not recommended in the third consideration, the CRC shall reject it (Para 5).
- Trainee Recommendation: Restricted to Multi-Tasking Staff cadre only (Para 6).
- Age of Case: Time gap between date of death/medical retirement and date of application. Where all dependents were minor at the time of death/retirement, time runs from the date the first dependent becomes major (Para 7).
- Belated Cases: Cases more than 5 years old from the date of death/medical retirement to the date of application are belated (Para 8).
- Missing Person Cases: Application accepted only after 2 years of date of FIR reporting the official as missing (Para 9).
- Circle-Specific Vacancy: Vacancies utilised by a Circle for compassionate appointment in a year shall not exceed 5% of DR Quota Group C vacancies. Unutilised vacancies of a year add to DR vacancies of next year (Para 10).
- PAOs, Civil/Electrical Wing: Vacancies arising in these are also to be taken into consideration.



- Place of Posting: As far as administratively feasible, the appointee will be posted at a place as per preference indicated, or near home town or in same division (Para 12).
- CRC Meeting Schedule: For death/retirement up to 31 December of a year, the cut-off date for receipt of applications is 31 January of the following year, and the CRC meeting is held in April of the following year (Para 13).

### 21.3 Rejection of Cases

**RMPS-2022 Para 5 — Three-Time Rule:** Each case must be considered three times in a row. After the third consideration, if not recommended, the CRC SHALL reject the case. Past applications not categorically rejected by previous CRCs that have not undergone three considerations must be reconsidered (till completion of 3 considerations) where CRC shall categorically record one of: (a) Recommended for appointment; (b) Not recommended in current year due to paucity of vacancies — to be considered by next CRC; or (c) Rejected. Once an application has been rejected and acceptance recorded by the competent authority, the candidature cannot be considered again except by court direction or discovery of new facts.

### 21.4 Validity & Effect

The RMPS-2022 guidelines came into effect with immediate effect from 23.03.2022. All CRC meetings on or after 23.03.2022 are to be conducted strictly as per these guidelines. Cases already considered by previous CRC under earlier RMPS shall not be reopened.

### 21.5 Online Processing

The Department of Posts has decided to develop a module for online processing of compassionate appointment cases, to improve transparency and minimize delays. This is in furtherance of the Voluntary Disclosure requirement of DoP&T O.M. dated 20.05.2019.



## Chapter 22 — 100-Point Relative Merit Point System (Variables)

### 22.1 The 10 Variables (100 Points) — DoP RMPS-2022 Annexure

Under the RMPS-2022 of the Department of Posts (Annexure to letter No. 17-1/2022-SPG-II dated 23.03.2022, retaining the slab structure of letter dated 28.09.2020), the 100 points are distributed across the following 10 attributes:

| S.No.  | Attribute / Variable                                                                                                                      | Max Points |
|--------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| (i)    | Basic family pension / pension / monthly amount received under NPS                                                                        | 20         |
| (ii)   | Lump sum amount received by family on death / medical retirement — DCRG, CGEGIS, GPF, lump sum under NPS & Leave Encashment               | 10         |
| (iii)  | Monthly income of earning member of family AND income from property                                                                       | 5          |
| (iv)   | Immovable / Movable property including fixed deposits / bank deposits / investments etc. — but excluding the lump sum under (ii) above    | 5          |
| (v)    | Number of dependents                                                                                                                      | 8          |
| (vi)   | Number of unmarried daughters                                                                                                             | 8          |
| (vii)  | Number of minor children                                                                                                                  | 8          |
| (viii) | Left over service of the deceased / medically retired employee (had he/she continued)                                                     | 14         |
| (ix)   | Immediate relief points — based on age of the case (date of death / medical retirement to date of application)                            | 12         |
| (x)    | Physically / Mentally Challenged and chronic disease cases (applicant / dependent family member is PwD or suffering from listed diseases) | 10         |
|        | TOTAL                                                                                                                                     | 100        |

## 22.2 Detailed Slabs — High-Yield for MCQs

### (i) Basic Family Pension / Pension / Monthly NPS amount (Max 20)

| Slab (₹)         | Points |
|------------------|--------|
| Up to 9,000      | 20     |
| 9,001 to 12,000  | 18     |
| 12,001 to 15,000 | 16     |
| 15,001 to 18,000 | 14     |
| 18,001 to 21,000 | 12     |
| 21,001 to 24,000 | 10     |
| 24,001 to 27,000 | 8      |
| 27,001 to 30,000 | 6      |
| 30,001 to 33,000 | 4      |
| 33,001 to 36,000 | 2      |
| Above 36,000     | 0      |

### (ii) Lump sum amount — DCRG / CGEGIS / GPF / NPS lumpsum / Leave Encashment (Max 10)

| Slab (₹)               | Points |
|------------------------|--------|
| Up to 3,00,000         | 10     |
| 3,00,001 to 4,00,000   | 9      |
| 4,00,001 to 5,00,000   | 8      |
| 5,00,001 to 6,00,000   | 7      |
| 6,00,001 to 7,00,000   | 6      |
| 7,00,001 to 8,00,000   | 5      |
| 8,00,001 to 9,00,000   | 4      |
| 9,00,001 to 10,00,000  | 3      |
| 10,00,001 to 11,00,000 | 2      |
| 11,00,001 to 12,00,000 | 1      |
| Above 12,00,000        | 0      |

**(iii) Monthly income of earning member & income from property (Max 5)**

| Slab (₹)         | Points |
|------------------|--------|
| No income        | 5      |
| 7,500 or less    | 4      |
| 7,501 to 10,500  | 3      |
| 10,501 to 13,500 | 2      |
| 13,501 to 16,500 | 1      |
| 16,501 and above | 0      |

**(iv) Immovable / Movable Property (Max 5) — excluding lump sum under (ii)**

| Slab (₹)               | Points |
|------------------------|--------|
| Nil                    | 5      |
| Up to 5,00,000         | 4      |
| 5,00,001 to 10,00,000  | 3      |
| 10,00,001 to 20,00,000 | 2      |
| 20,00,001 to 30,00,000 | 1      |
| Above 30,00,000        | 0      |

**(v) / (vi) / (vii) Dependents / Unmarried Daughters / Minor Children — Identical Slab (Max 8 each)**

| Number      | Points |
|-------------|--------|
| 2 and above | 8      |
| 1           | 4      |
| 0           | 0      |

**(viii) Left over Service (Max 14)**

| Left over service              | Points |
|--------------------------------|--------|
| Over 25 years                  | 14     |
| Over 20 years & up to 25 years | 12     |
| Over 15 years & up to 20 years | 10     |

| Left over service              | Points |
|--------------------------------|--------|
| Over 10 years & up to 15 years | 8      |
| Over 5 years & up to 10 years  | 6      |
| Over 2 years & up to 5 years   | 4      |
| Less than 2 years              | 2      |

**(ix) Immediate Relief – Age of the Case (Max 12)**

| Age of case                    | Points |
|--------------------------------|--------|
| Less than 3 years old          | 12     |
| 3 years to less than 6 years   | 8      |
| 6 years to less than 9 years   | 6      |
| 9 years to less than 12 years  | 4      |
| 12 years to less than 15 years | 2      |
| 15 years and above             | 0      |

**Important Note on (ix):** Age of the case is reckoned from the date of death/medical retirement. If a minor applies for compassionate appointment after attaining majority, the period of the case is counted from the date on which he/she became a major.

**(x) Physically/Mentally Challenged and Chronic Disease Cases (Max 10)**

| Condition                                                                                                                                                           | Points |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|
| Applicant is a Person with Disability                                                                                                                               | 10     |
| A dependent family member (other than the applicant) of the deceased is PwD                                                                                         | 6      |
| A dependent family member is suffering from AIDS, Cancer, Kidney failure, Heart attack, Liver Cirrhosis, Organ transplantation (liver/heart/kidney), or Alzheimer's | 3      |

**PwD Definition:** The disability as defined by DoP&T for reservation for Persons with Disabilities (now PwBDs under the RPwD Act, 2016) shall be ensured. Related certificates must be obtained accordingly.

### 22.3 Bonus Points (Max 15) — Over and Above the 100

- 15 Bonus points are awarded to the applicant if she is the widow of the deceased employee, OR the wife of an employee who has retired on medical grounds.
- Bonus points are over and above the 100-point base — maximum possible score is 115 points.
- Bonus points do not apply to male applicants or to children of the deceased.

### 22.4 Verification Authority

Each variable is verified by Divisional/Regional/Circle authorities by reference to specified documents:

- Items (i), (ii), (v), (vii), (viii) and (ix): from service records; certified by Divisional/Regional/Circle authority.
- Items (iii) and (iv): from bank statements, ITR, certificate from Revenue authorities, and applicant's affidavit.
- Item (vi): from documents/affidavit/certificate issued by Revenue/Municipal authorities.
- Item (x): based on PwBD certificate (UDID) or medical certificate from a competent medical authority for chronic diseases.

### 22.5 Procedure for Score Calculation & Selection

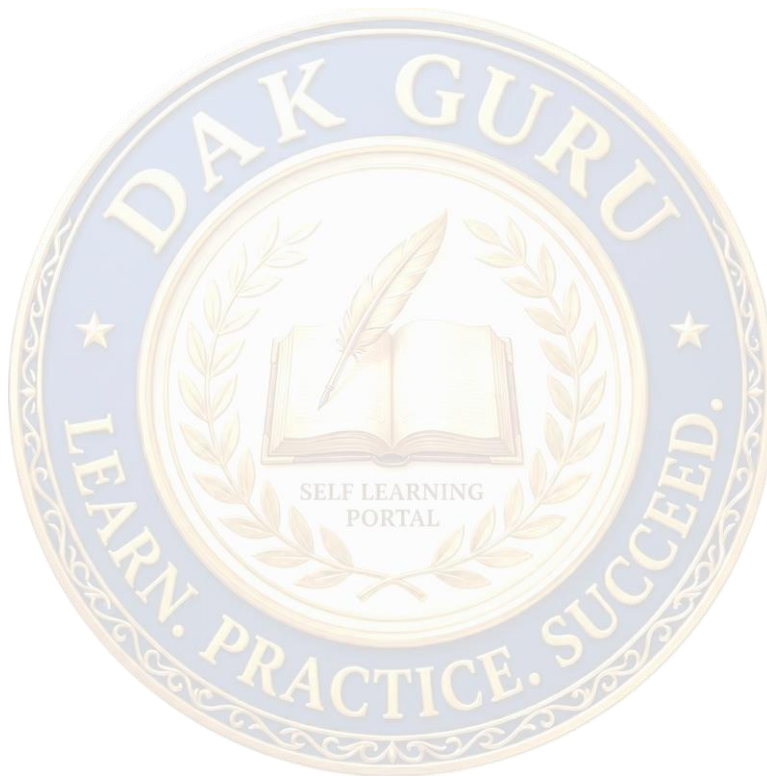
- Each applicant's RMP is calculated by summing points across all 10 variables (plus bonus, if applicable).
- The applicant scoring the highest is recommended for appointment, subject to availability of vacancy in the relevant cadre/circle.
- Tie-breaking factors (where two or more applicants score the same total) — lower age of case, more minor children, lower terminal benefits.
- Below the cut-off score: case may be either recommended for next CRC (paucity of vacancies) or rejected (third consideration).

### 22.6 Treatment of NPS Lump Sum

Under the National Pension System (NPS), the lump sum amount received by the family on death of the Government servant is to be reckoned under Variable (ii) — together with DCRG,



CGEGIS, GPF, and Leave Encashment. Monthly amount received under NPS (where opted as pension) is reckoned under Variable (i) along with basic family pension/pension.



## Chapter 23 — Special Cases — Missing Person, Belated, Suicide & Deemed Rejected

### 23.1 Missing Person Cases

**RMPS-2022 Para 9:** In case of a missing person, the application for compassionate appointment will be accepted only after two years from the date of report of the missing of the official as mentioned in the FIR. All conditions related to compassionate appointment to dependents of a missing official as prescribed by DoP&T are to be ensured.

#### *DoP&T Conditions for Missing Person Cases*

- First Information Report (FIR) must be lodged immediately with the police authorities on the date of disappearance.
- Family must produce a report from police authorities certifying the continued missing status.
- Indemnity bond may be executed by the dependent family to safeguard the interest of Government in case the missing employee subsequently re-appears.
- Once the missing official re-appears, the appointment given on compassionate grounds is to be reviewed.

### 23.2 Belated Cases

**RMPS-2022 Para 8:** Cases which are more than 5 years old (from the date of death / retirement on medical grounds up to the date of application) are termed as belated cases. The 5-year period is strictly counted irrespective of whether all dependents were minor at the time of death / retirement.

#### *Treatment of Belated Cases*

- Belated cases are subjected to additional scrutiny — applicant must explain why application was delayed.
- Reduced weightage may be given for the "age of case" variable in RMPS (0 points if age of case is 15 years and above).
- Genuineness of indigency at the time of application becomes the predominant factor.

### 23.3 Death by Suicide

**Important Clarification:** Death by suicide of a Government servant during service has been expressly included within the ambit of "death while in service" by the DoP&T Master Circular dated 02.08.2022. The earlier ambiguity has been resolved — suicide deaths are NOT excluded, and dependents are eligible for compassionate appointment subject to other conditions.

### 23.4 Disabled / Medically Retired Cases

Where a Government servant is retired on medical grounds under Rule 2 of CCS (Medical Examination) Rules, 1957 before attaining the age of 55 years (57 years in case of erstwhile Group D), a dependent family member is eligible for compassionate appointment. The conditions are:

- Medical Board certificate showing permanent incapacity for further service.
- The retiring Government servant must consent in writing to compassionate appointment of the dependent.
- Indigency assessment as on date of medical retirement.

### 23.5 Children of Void / Voidable Marriages

The Supreme Court has held that children of a void marriage (a marriage solemnised in violation of conditions of the Hindu Marriage Act etc.) are legitimate offspring under Section 16 of the Hindu Marriage Act, and they cannot be denied the benefits of compassionate appointment. DoP&T has issued instructions to give effect to this jurisprudence.

### 23.6 Pending Disciplinary Proceedings

Where a Government servant dies during pendency of disciplinary proceedings, compassionate appointment is generally permissible, but each case is to be considered on merits. The administrative authority may take into account the nature of charges and stage of proceedings before deciding.

### 23.7 "Deemed Rejected" Categories — DoP Clarification dated 20.07.2023

To clear the confusion arising in various Circles on the operation of the three-time-rejection rule (Para 5 of RMPS-2022), the Postal Directorate issued a clarification vide letter No. 17-1/2022-SPG-II dated 20.07.2023. The clarification expressly creates two categories of past cases:

#### *(a) Categorical Rejection — Para 5 of RMPS-2022*

- CRC shall reject a case/application on the third consideration if not recommended at that stage based on RMP.
- An incomplete case should NOT be considered by CRC. If an incomplete case was considered in the past, that consideration shall not be counted for the purpose of the 3-time consideration rule.
- It is not necessary to consider a case three times continuously in a row for past cases. For fresh cases (after RMPS-2022), they must be considered 3 times continuously.

#### **(b) Deemed Rejected-I**

**Deemed Rejected-I:** In past CRC minutes of some Circles, candidates were listed under categories such as 'Recommended', 'Not Recommended', and 'Recommended for reconsideration by next CRC' — without using a 'Rejected' category. Circles wrongly treated 'Not Recommended' as 'Rejected'. Such past candidates must now be considered for a total of 3 times by CRC, IF they are NOT listed under 'Deemed Rejected-I'. The Circle is directed to prepare a list of such past candidates as 'Deemed Rejected-I' with the approval of the Head of Circle.

#### **(c) Deemed Rejected-II**

**Deemed Rejected-II:** Past applications/cases considered for a total of 3 times or more (whether or not in 3 continuous CRC meetings) in previous CRCs shall be considered deemed rejected. A list of such candidates is to be made under 'Deemed Rejected-II' category with the approval of the Head of Circle. After issuance of RMPS-2022, such cases shall NOT be placed before CRC, even if a past CRC had recommended reconsideration.

#### **(d) Cases Pending in Court**

**Court-Pending Cases:** If a case has already been considered for 3 or more times in the past AND is pending before a court as on 23.03.2022 (date of issue of RMPS-2022), it may be reconsidered as per the directions of the Court — for ONE MORE TIME only.

*[Source: DoP letter No. 17-1/2022-SPG-II dated 20.07.2023 — Clarification on Relative Merit Points and Procedure under RMPS-2022.]*

## Chapter 24 — Age Relaxation, Pay Fixation, Maintenance Undertaking

### 24.1 Age Relaxation

Where an applicant has crossed the maximum age limit prescribed for the post to which he is being considered for compassionate appointment as on the date of application, age relaxation will be required and must be granted by the competent authority. The lower age limit, however, cannot in any case be relaxed below 18 years of age as on the date of application.

**Authority for Age Relaxation:** The authority competent to take a final decision for making compassionate appointment in a case is also competent to grant relaxation of upper age limit for making such appointment.

### 24.2 Educational Qualification — Trainee Provision

In exceptional circumstances, Government may consider recruiting persons not immediately meeting the minimum educational standards. Such persons may be engaged as trainees who:

- Will be paid emoluments equal to the minimum (first cell) of Pay Level-1 (Rs. 18,000–56,900) — pre-revised -15 pay band — during the training period;
- Will be granted all applicable Allowances (DA, HRA, TA) at admissible rates;
- Will be given regular pay band and grade pay only on acquiring the minimum qualification prescribed under the Recruitment Rules.

[Source: Para 1 of O.M. No. 14014/2/2009-Estt(D) dated 11.12.2009; Para 2 of O.M. dated 09.10.2017 (7th CPC pay fixation).]

**DoP Restriction (RMPS-2022 Para 6):** Recommendations as 'Trainee' should be restricted to Multi-Tasking Staff (MTS) cadre only in the Department of Posts.

### 24.3 Pay Fixation

- The trainee, on completion of training and acquisition of minimum educational qualification, is appointed in the regular pay band of the post.
- Where the candidate already possesses minimum qualification at appointment, pay is fixed in the relevant Pay Level on the date of joining.
- No protection of past pay is given (the appointment being de novo).

### 24.4 Exemption from Typing Test



In the matter of exemption from the requirement of passing the typing test, those appointed on compassionate grounds to the post of Lower Division Clerk (LDC) will be governed by general orders issued in this regard:

- By the CS Division of DoP&T if the post is included in the Central Secretariat Clerical Service; or
- By the Ministry/Department concerned, if the post is included in the office-specific Clerical Service.

#### 24.5 Maintenance Undertaking — Annexure to Master Circular

The compassionate appointee is required to execute the prescribed Undertaking (Annexure to the Master Circular dated 02.08.2022) at the time of joining. The Undertaking essentially declares:

- That he/she will maintain properly the other family members who were dependent on the deceased / medically retired Government servant;
- That if at any time it is proved that family members are being neglected or are not being maintained properly, the appointment may be terminated forthwith;
- That the undertaking is legally enforceable and is incorporated as an essential condition of the appointment.

*[Source: Validated by Ministry of Law (Department of Legal Affairs); incorporated in DoP&T's standard Annexure.]*

#### 24.6 Recommendation Authority

**DoP&T 23.08.2021 — Para xv:** The recommendation of the Committee should be placed before the competent authority for a decision. If the competent authority disagrees with the Committee's recommendation, the case may be referred to the next higher authority for a decision.

#### 24.7 Reservation Adjustment

A person appointed on compassionate grounds is to be adjusted in the reservation register / reservation roster register against the appropriate category — SC / ST / OBC / EWS / UR — depending upon the category to which he belongs. An unreserved category candidate is adjusted against an unreserved vacancy. A vacancy reserved for SC/ST/OBC cannot be filled by a non-SC/ST/OBC candidate, as the case may be.

**Appendix A — Important OMs/Circulars (Quick Reference)**

| Sl. | OM / Notification (No. & Date)                           | Subject                                                                                                     |
|-----|----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1.  | DoP&T O.M. No. 36011/1/2022-Estt(Res-I) dated 28.03.2024 | Reservation for SCs/STs/OBCs/PwDs/EWS in Posts and Services in Central Government — Latest Consolidating OM |
| 2.  | DoP&T Letter dated 15.03.2024                            | Modification in instructions regarding authorities competent to issue Caste / Income & Asset Certificates   |
| 3.  | DoP&T O.M. dated 09.10.2024                              | Reservation in promotion to PwBDs — grant of notional promotion w.e.f. 30.06.2016                           |
| 4.  | DoP&T O.M. dated 22.10.2024                              | Training of Liaison Officers by ISTM and iGOT Karmayogi                                                     |
| 5.  | DoP&T O.M. dated 25.12.2025                              | Compendium of Guidelines on Reservation for Ex-Servicemen                                                   |
| 6.  | DoP&T Notification dated 09.02.2026                      | Amendment in Rule 2 of Ex-Servicemen (Re-employment) Rules, 1979                                            |
| 7.  | DoP&T O.M. No. 36039/1/2019-Estt(Res) dated 31.01.2019   | 10% Reservation for EWS                                                                                     |
| 8.  | DoP&T O.M. No. 36033/1/2013-Estt(Res) dated 13.09.2017   | Revision of OBC creamy layer income limit to Rs. 8 lakh p.a.                                                |
| 9.  | DoP&T O.M. No. DOPT-1711450898768 dated 04.03.2024       | Consolidated Instructions on Recruitment and Promotion for Sportspersons                                    |
| 10. | DoP&T O.M. No. DOPT-1668767575965 dated 18.11.2022       | List of 65 sports disciplines for meritorious sportspersons                                                 |
| 11. | DoP&T (Estt. Pay) dated 15.09.2022                       | Other Incentives to Sportspersons — Increments, Special Casual Leave, TA/DA                                 |

| Sl. | OM / Notification (No. & Date)                                            | Subject                                                                                      |
|-----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 12. | DoP&T O.M. No. 14014/1/2022-Estt(D) dated 02.08.2022 (DOPT-1667555281194) | Master Circular on Scheme of Compassionate Appointment                                       |
| 13. | DoP&T O.M. No. 43019/9/2019-Estt(D) dated 23.08.2021                      | Consolidated Instructions on Compassionate Appointment — Replacement of Para 13 (Procedure)  |
| 14. | DoP&T O.M. dated 20.05.2019                                               | Voluntary disclosure of compassionate appointment information on Ministry/Department website |
| 15. | DoP Letter No. 17-1/2022-SPG-II dated 23.03.2022                          | RMPS-2022 — Revised Relative Merit Points System for compassionate appointment in DoP        |
| 16. | DoP Letter No. 17-1/2022-SPG-II dated 20.07.2023                          | Clarification on RMPS-2022 — 'Deemed Rejected-I' and 'Deemed Rejected-II' categories         |
| 17. | DoP Letter No. W-17/55/2022-SPN-I dated 08.11.2023                        | Sports Quota Recruitment in DoP — PA/SA, Postman/Mail Guard, MTS                             |
| 18. | DoP Order dated 28.01.2026                                                | Revised disability proforma under RPwD Amendment Rules, 2024 adopted by DoP                  |

## Appendix B — Frequently-Asked One-Liners for MCQs

The following one-liner facts are high-yield for objective questions in Paper III. Memorise them verbatim:

1. Reservation for SC = 15%, ST = 7.5%, OBC = 27% (direct recruitment by open competition); for "otherwise than open competition" mode: SC 16.66%, ST 7.5%, OBC 25.84%.
2. EWS reservation = 10% (Article 16(6), introduced w.e.f. 01.02.2019 by DoP&T OM dated 31.01.2019).
3. PwBD reservation = 4% (1% in each of the four classes of benchmark disabilities) under RPwD Act, 2016.
4. Ex-Servicemen reservation: 10% in Group C, 20% in Group D, 10% in Group B (non-gazetted). No reservation in Group A and Group B (Gazetted).
5. OBC creamy layer income limit (current): Rs. 8.00 lakh per annum (revised w.e.f. 01.09.2017 vide DoP&T OM dated 13.09.2017).
6. EWS income ceiling: Rs. 8.00 lakh per annum gross family income, with three asset exclusions (5 acres agricultural land / 1000 sq. ft. flat / 100 sq. yards plot in notified municipality / 200 sq. yards plot elsewhere).
7. Latest consolidated reservation OM: DoP&T O.M. No. 36011/1/2022-Estt(Res-I) dated 28.03.2024.
8. 50% ceiling on reservation: laid down by Supreme Court in Indra Sawhney v. Union of India (1992); EWS 10% is over and above this ceiling.
9. Post-based reservation roster: introduced vide DoP&T OM No. 36012/2/96-Estt(Res) dated 02.07.1997 following R.K. Sabharwal v. State of Punjab (1995).
10. Reservation in promotion: only for SC (15%) and ST (7.5%) — no reservation in promotion for OBC, EWS, or others.
11. PwBD promotion: 4% reservation (notional promotion w.e.f. 30.06.2016 vide DoP&T O.M. dated 09.10.2024) following Siddaraju v. State of Karnataka.
12. Sports quota in Central Government: up to 5% of DR vacancies in Group C / erstwhile Group D posts.
13. Sports quota latest OM: DoP&T O.M. No. DOPT-1711450898768 dated 04.03.2024 (consolidating all earlier instructions).
14. Sports quota originating OM: DoP&T O.M. No. 14015/1/76-Estt(D) dated 04.08.1980.

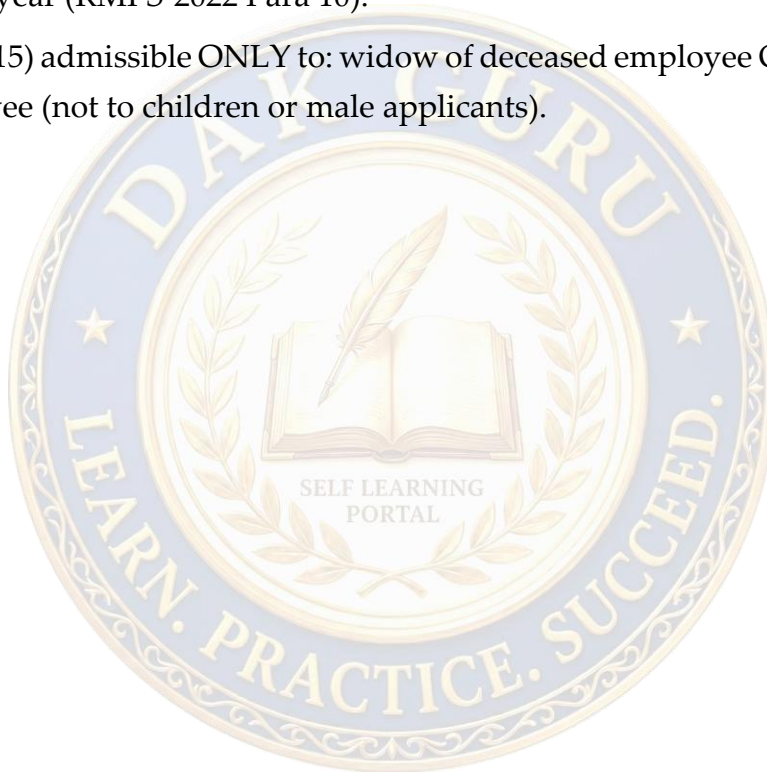


15. Number of recognised sports disciplines for sports quota: 65 (DoP&T O.M. dated 18.11.2022).
16. Sports persons age relaxation: 5 years (general), 10 years (SC/ST).
17. First Preference in sports quota: candidates who represented the COUNTRY in INTERNATIONAL competition with clearance of Department of Sports.
18. Sports persons appointed are adjusted against the SC/ST/OBC/EWS/UR vertical roster point of their category — sports quota is HORIZONTAL.
19. Sports quota recruitment is by advertisement in Employment News (DoP uses online portal [dopsportsrecruitment.cept.gov.in](https://dopsportsrecruitment.cept.gov.in)) — NOT by inviting names from any other source.
20. Special Casual Leave for sportspersons: up to 30 days per calendar year (HoD may grant beyond 30 days on merits).
21. Compassionate appointment ceiling: up to 5% of DR vacancies in Group C posts.
22. Compassionate appointment Master Circular: DoP&T O.M. No. 14014/1/2022-Estt(D) dated 02.08.2022 (DOPT-1667555281194).
23. Compassionate appointment procedure (Replacement of Para 13): DoP&T OM dated 23.08.2021.
24. DoP Compassionate Appointment Scheme: RMPS-2022 issued vide letter No. 17-1/2022-SPG-II dated 23.03.2022.
25. DoP Clarification on RMPS-2022 rejection rule: DoP letter No. 17-1/2022-SPG-II dated 20.07.2023.
26. RMPS = 100 points across 10 variables + 15 bonus points (for widow/wife). Maximum possible = 115 points.
27. Variable (i) of RMPS = Basic family pension / pension / monthly NPS amount — MAX 20 POINTS (highest).
28. Variable (viii) of RMPS = Left over Service — MAX 14 POINTS (over 25 years left = 14 points).
29. Variable (ix) of RMPS = Immediate Relief (age of case) — MAX 12 POINTS (less than 3 years old = 12 points).
30. Variable (x) of RMPS = PwD / Chronic disease — MAX 10 POINTS (applicant is PwD = 10 points).
31. Variables (v), (vi), (vii) of RMPS — No. of dependents, unmarried daughters, minor children — MAX 8 EACH; 2 and above = 8 points; 1 = 4 points; 0 = 0.



32. Variable (ii) of RMPS = Lump sum amount (DCRG/CGEGIS/GPF/NPS lumpsum/Leave Encashment) — MAX 10 POINTS; up to Rs. 3 lakh = 10 points; above Rs. 12 lakh = 0.
33. Variables (iii) and (iv) of RMPS — monthly income AND movable/immovable property — MAX 5 EACH.
34. Cut-off date for indigency: date of death / date of retirement on medical grounds (NOT date of CRC).
35. Cut-off for applications: 31 January of following year for deaths/medical retirements up to 31 December.
36. CRC meeting schedule: April of the year following vacancy year.
37. Missing person case: application accepted only after 2 YEARS from date of FIR.
38. Belated case: more than 5 YEARS from death/medical retirement to application.
39. Three-Time Rule: case considered max 3 times; rejected on third consideration if not recommended.
40. Deemed Rejected-I: past cases where 'Not Recommended' was wrongly treated as 'Rejected' — list to be prepared by Head of Circle.
41. Deemed Rejected-II: cases already considered 3 or more times in past — list under approval of Head of Circle; not to be placed before CRC again.
42. Court-pending cases (as on 23.03.2022) considered 3+ times: may be reconsidered ONE MORE TIME only as per court direction.
43. Place of posting (compassionate): as far as feasible, preference indicated / near home town / same division.
44. Reservation in compassionate appointment: appointee adjusted against the vertical category point (SC/ST/OBC/EWS/UR) of his social category.
45. 5% ceiling for compassionate appointment CANNOT be exceeded by using sports quota or other vacancies.
46. Trainee provision: emoluments equal to minimum of Pay Level-1 (Rs. 18,000); DA/HRA/TA admissible; DoP restricts trainee status to MTS cadre only.
47. Death by suicide: covered under "death while in service" — dependents eligible for compassionate appointment.
48. Children of void marriage: legitimate offspring; eligible for compassionate appointment (Supreme Court).

49. Married son: eligible for compassionate appointment subject to other conditions (DoP&T OM dated 05.09.2016).
50. Authority to issue caste certificates: notified by State Government / UT (DoP&T letter dated 15.03.2024).
51. Authority to grant age relaxation in compassionate appointment: the authority competent to make the appointment itself.
52. Voluntary disclosure requirement: Ministry/Department must publish compassionate appointment information on website (DoP&T OM dated 20.05.2019).
53. DoP Compassionate Appointment vacancies cap: not more than 5% of DR Quota Group C vacancies in a year (RMPS-2022 Para 10).
54. Bonus points (15) admissible ONLY to: widow of deceased employee OR wife of medically-retired employee (not to children or male applicants).



## Appendix C — Practice MCQs with Answer Key

Twenty representative MCQs framed in the style of LDCE Paper III. The answer key is at the end.

**Q1.** The percentage of reservation for OBCs in direct recruitment by open competition on all-India basis is:

- (a) 25%
- (b) 25.84%
- (c) 27%
- (d) 30%

**Q2.** Reservation for EWS in Central Government services was introduced w.e.f.:

- (a) 31.01.2019
- (b) 01.02.2019
- (c) 01.04.2019
- (d) 01.01.2020

**Q3.** The current income ceiling for determining OBC creamy layer is:

- (a) Rs. 6.00 lakh per annum
- (b) Rs. 7.50 lakh per annum
- (c) Rs. 8.00 lakh per annum
- (d) Rs. 10.00 lakh per annum

**Q4.** The latest consolidated DoP&T OM on reservation for SCs/STs/OBCs/PwBDs/EWS is dated:

- (a) 14.10.2022
- (b) 28.03.2024
- (c) 09.10.2024
- (d) 25.12.2025

**Q5.** Under the RPwD Act, 2016, the reservation for Persons with Benchmark Disabilities is:

- (a) 3% in three categories
- (b) 4% in four categories
- (c) 5% in five categories
- (d) 4% in three categories

**Q6.** Reservation in promotion is available to:

- (a) SC, ST and OBC
- (b) SC and ST only
- (c) SC, ST and EWS
- (d) All reserved categories

**Q7.** The 50% ceiling on reservation was laid down by the Supreme Court in:

- (a) Indra Sawhney v. Union of India
- (b) M. Nagaraj v. Union of India
- (c) R.K. Sabharwal v. State of Punjab
- (d) Jarnail Singh v. Lachmi Narain Gupta

**Q8.** Post-based reservation roster system was introduced by DoP&T OM dated:

- (a) 02.07.1997
- (b) 14.10.2022
- (c) 23.08.2021
- (d) 28.03.2024

**Q9.** The latest DoP&T consolidated instructions on sports persons reservation are dated:

- (a) 04.08.1980
- (b) 04.05.1995
- (c) 03.10.2013
- (d) 04.03.2024

**Q10.** The maximum ceiling of compassionate appointment in a year is what % of DR vacancies in Group C posts?

- (a) 3%
- (b) 5%
- (c) 7%
- (d) 10%

**Q11.** The DoP&T Master Circular on compassionate appointment is dated:

- (a) 16.01.2013
- (b) 23.08.2021
- (c) 02.08.2022

(d) 23.03.2022

**Q12.** The Revised Relative Merit Points System (RMPS-2022) of DoP was issued vide letter dated:

- (a) 28.09.2020
- (b) 23.03.2022
- (c) 02.08.2022
- (d) 23.08.2021

**Q13.** Total maximum points under DoP RMPS-2022 (including bonus points) are:

- (a) 100
- (b) 115
- (c) 120
- (d) 125

**Q14.** Bonus points under RMPS-2022 are admissible to:

- (a) Widow of deceased employee / wife of medically retired employee
- (b) Minor child of deceased
- (c) Unmarried daughter only
- (d) Any female applicant

**Q15.** In a missing person case, application for compassionate appointment is accepted only after:

- (a) 1 year of FIR
- (b) 2 years of FIR
- (c) 3 years of FIR
- (d) 7 years of FIR

**Q16.** A belated compassionate appointment case is one where the gap between death/medical retirement and application is more than:

- (a) 1 year
- (b) 3 years
- (c) 5 years
- (d) 7 years

**Q17.** The First Preference under sports quota recruitment is given to candidates who:

- (a) Have won medals in Junior National Championships



- (b) Have represented the country in International Competition with clearance of Department of Sports
- (c) Have represented their University in Inter-University tournaments
- (d) Are Khelo India Games medal winners

**Q18.** Sports persons appointed under sports quota are adjusted against:

- (a) A separate sports category roster point
- (b) The General/UR roster point only
- (c) The vertical roster point of the SC/ST/OBC/EWS/UR category to which they belong
- (d) Any vacant roster point in the cadre

**Q19.** The DoP&T limit for age relaxation for sports persons (general candidates) is:

- (a) 3 years
- (b) 5 years
- (c) 7 years
- (d) 10 years

**Q20.** Compassionate appointment cannot be given in:

- (a) Group C posts
- (b) Erstwhile Group D / MTS posts
- (c) Group B (non-gazetted) posts
- (d) Group A and Group B (Gazetted) posts

**Q21.** Under RMPS-2022, the variable carrying the HIGHEST maximum points is:

- (a) Left over service (14)
- (b) Basic family pension / pension / monthly NPS amount (20)
- (c) Immediate Relief (12)
- (d) PwD / Chronic disease cases (10)

**Q22.** Under RMPS-2022, if a family receives basic family pension of Rs. 8,500/-, how many points will it get under Variable (i)?

- (a) 16
- (b) 18
- (c) 20
- (d) 14

**Q23.** Under RMPS-2022, if a family receives lump sum (DCRG+CGEGIS+GPF+Leave Encashment) of Rs. 2,80,000, how many points will it get under Variable (ii)?

- (a) 8
- (b) 9
- (c) 10
- (d) 6

**Q24.** Under RMPS-2022, the left over service of 27 years carries:

- (a) 10 points
- (b) 12 points
- (c) 14 points
- (d) 16 points

**Q25.** Under RMPS-2022, an applicant who is herself a Person with Disability gets how many points under Variable (x)?

- (a) 3
- (b) 6
- (c) 10
- (d) 5

**Q26.** The DoP letter clarifying "Deemed Rejected-I" and "Deemed Rejected-II" categories is dated:

- (a) 23.03.2022
- (b) 02.08.2022
- (c) 23.08.2021
- (d) 20.07.2023

**Q27.** For deaths/medical retirements occurring up to 31st December of a year, the cut-off date for receipt of compassionate appointment application is:

- (a) 28 February of next year
- (b) 31 January of next year
- (c) 31 March of next year
- (d) 30 April of next year

**Q28.** The DoP&T O.M. on PwBD notional promotion w.e.f. 30.06.2016 is dated:

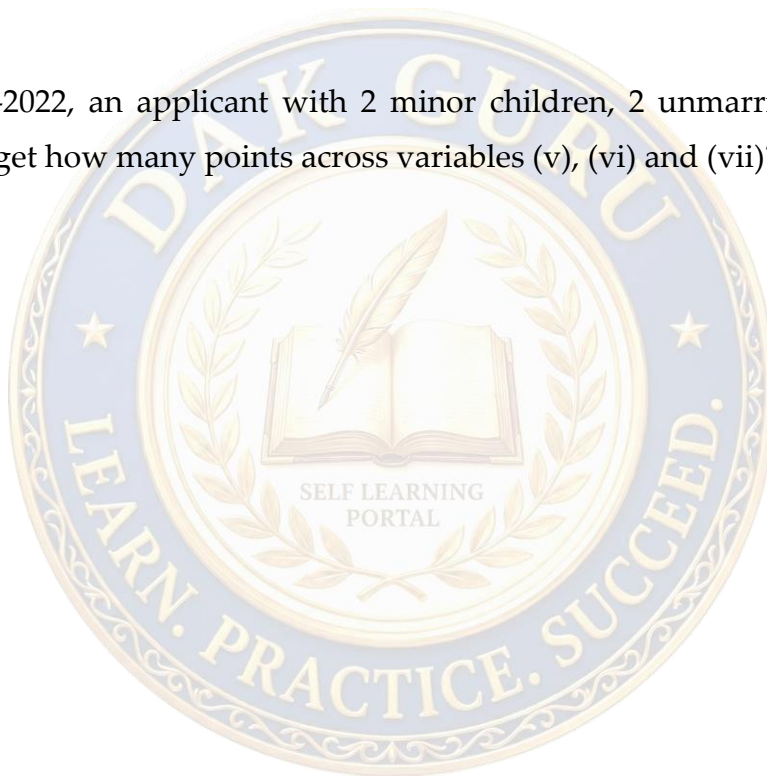
- (a) 28.12.2023
- (b) 09.10.2024
- (c) 28.03.2024
- (d) 22.10.2024

**Q29.** The number of sports disciplines recognised for sports quota recruitment in Central Government is:

- (a) 45
- (b) 55
- (c) 65
- (d) 75

**Q30.** Under RMPS-2022, an applicant with 2 minor children, 2 unmarried daughters and 2 dependents would get how many points across variables (v), (vi) and (vii)?

- (a) 16
- (b) 20
- (c) 24
- (d) 12



## Answer Key — Appendix C

| Q1: (c)  | Q2: (b)  | Q3: (c)  | Q4: (b)  | Q5: (b)  |
|----------|----------|----------|----------|----------|
| Q6: (b)  | Q7: (a)  | Q8: (a)  | Q9: (d)  | Q10: (b) |
| Q11: (c) | Q12: (b) | Q13: (b) | Q14: (a) | Q15: (b) |
| Q16: (c) | Q17: (b) | Q18: (c) | Q19: (b) | Q20: (d) |
| Q21: (b) | Q22: (c) | Q23: (c) | Q24: (c) | Q25: (c) |
| Q26: (d) | Q27: (b) | Q28: (b) | Q29: (c) | Q30: (c) |

— — END OF STUDY NOTES — —

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